



Board of Directors Policy & Procedure

A collection of the policies and procedures set and maintained by the UTSU Board of Directors.

This document is maintained by the UTSU Governance Committee and Board of Directors.

Approval by the UTSU Board of Directors in **March 2026**.

This document does not cover other regulations in effect at the UTSU, including: the Bylaws; the Student Commons Rules & Regulations; the Personnel Policies Manual; the Clubs & Societies Handbook; the Senate Policies; and the Elections & Referenda Code.

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Note

Some policies are included in the UTSU Personnel Policies manual, which includes the organization's workplace policies, health and safety policies, and other policies which are either a legislative requirement for employees or are simply operational in nature.

Introduction & Administration

An introduction, administrative notes, and a template.

Not personnel policies. For the building policies and guidelines for the Student Commons building at 230 College St. please refer to the Student Commons Rules & Regulations.

Introduction

WELCOME TO THE UTSU

Founded in 1901, the University of Toronto's Students' Union (UTSU) is the official student government for the more than 40,000 full time undergraduate students at the University of Toronto St. George campus. The UTSU is a student government and not-for-profit organization operating separately from the University of Toronto administration.

The UTSU is governed by the Board of Directors and managed by the Executive Committee. This policy manual governs the Board of Directors at the UTSU supporting the operations of the organization.

Mission

1. To safeguard the individual rights of the student, regardless of race, colour, age, mental or physical ability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, creed, religion, personal beliefs, nationality, geographic or ethnic orientation, citizenship, class, or First Nations, Inuit, and Metis status;
2. To foster the intellectual growth and moral awareness of the student in order to benefit them, the University of Toronto student community, and society;
3. To provide facilities for the services and activities which are in the interests of the University of Toronto student community;
4. To endeavour to bring about a fundamental redistribution of power so as to permit substantially greater participation by students in making those decisions which affect their lives;
5. To engage in research and discussion of the broad educational philosophy and principles affecting the University of Toronto student community;
6. To provide means of communication within the University of Toronto student community, among the campuses of the University of Toronto, with other members of the university community, with other universities, and with the general public;
7. To engage in discussion with municipal, provincial, and national governments on issues that affect the University of Toronto student community;
8. To encourage fruitful student employment and social action programs involving volunteer student resources;
9. To press for such action as may be necessary to make higher education accessible to all classes of Canadian society.

Administration

Force of Policies

1. The following statements establish the importance and contractual force of UTSU policies, including those contained within this policies and procedures manual.
 - a. All members of the UTSU Board of Directors, Executive Committee, and Senate, as well as all employees and other relevant stakeholders seeking to participate in processes at the UTSU, must familiarize themselves with this manual.
 - b. For questions about policies or for clarifications regarding interpretation, please contact the listed policy owner, the VP Finance & Operations, or the President.

Scope of Manual

2. This manual applies organization-wide and intends to provide a basis for consistent and appropriate decision-making on governance issues, including the following:
 - a. **Standing & Special Rules of Order (SRO)**, which complement Robert's Rules by allowing for additional rules to be used in parliamentary UTSU meetings;
 - b. **Terms of Reference (TOR)**, which govern the formal committees of the UTSU, their members, meetings, finances, and any additional information;
 - c. **Finance & Operations Policies (OFP)**, which govern the financial, legal, and other technically-oriented policies the organization is required to have; and
 - d. **People & Culture Policies (P&C)**, which govern broader 'people and culture' subjects that affect the entire organization. *Not personnel policies.
 - e. **General Policies**, simply consisting of the policies which cannot be as conveniently categorized into the above categories. Miscellaneous policies.
3. All policies in this manual will be:
 - a. Presented in a common format using an approved header system;
 - b. Formally considered, approved, and recorded by the Board of Directors;
 - c. Distributed to the Board of Directors;
 - d. Made available in the UTSU Public shared drive and at www.utsu.ca; and
 - e. Kept current at all times.
4. The provisions of this policy manual are subject to any federal, provincial, or territorial laws that may prohibit or restrict their applicability.

	AREA	CODE	[Code Title / Definition]	
	POLICY	00_	[Name of Policy]	
	OWNERS	[Position/Organ ultimately accountable for the policy]		
	AFFECTS	[i.e. Board of Directors, ____ Committee, etc]		
INTRODUCED		[Date]	REVIEWED	[Date]
AMENDMENT HISTORY		[Which dept. reviewed or amended, and when]		

[AAA-000] | Policy Template For Use

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. What is the overarching goal, rationale or purpose of this policy? What are some of the values and philosophies of the organization that inform this policy?
2. To whom does this policy apply to? Are there any specific provisions relating to the scope ? (i.e. does this policy only affect certain employment groups under certain circumstances?)

POLICY

3. The substantive terms of the policy. In general, guidelines should outline the various provisions of the policy. The guidelines should be written in clear, concise, and accessible language. Policy should not be too prescriptive.
4. If the policy affects different employment categories or groups differently, the guidelines should reflect that.
 - a. Sub-points can be used to further elaborate on key aspects of the policy

PROCEDURE

5. If your policy has an associated procedure, that procedure can be outlined in the same document. In general, procedures are required when something needs to be done consistently the same way, time after time.
6. Where the guidelines are more general, the procedure should be specific and prescriptive. Consider writing the procedure in such a way that it gives little-to-no room for error.

CITATIONS AND APPENDICES

Note if the policy has any forms or supporting appendices and add citations of materials used in drafting the policy or procedure.

Standing and Special Rules of Order (SRO)

In addition to *Robert's Rules*, these rules help us govern meetings of the different governance organs of the UTSU.

Not personnel policies. For the building policies and guidelines for the Student Commons building at 230 College St. please refer to the Student Commons Rules & Regulations.

	AREA	SRO	Special Rules of Order	
	POLICY	001	Meetings of the Board of Directors	
	OWNERS	Board of Directors, Governance Committee		
	AFFECTS	Meetings of the Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		30 Apr 2023	REVIEWED	N/A
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

SRO-001 | Board of Directors

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the Special Rules of Order which govern meetings of the UTSU Board of Directors, as defined in Article 3 of the Bylaws.
2. These Special Rules of Order are meant to be used in conjunction with the most recent version of the UTSU's parliamentary authority, *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*.

NOTICE & MEETINGS

3. Appropriate notice shall be given to members of the board and stakeholders for board meetings in a manner consistent with Article 3, Sections 5 and 6 of the Bylaws.
4. No later than seventy-two (72) hours prior to Regular Meetings of the Board, a meeting package shall be delivered electronically to members of the board and stakeholders which provides all the necessary information for the meeting, including:
 - a. The proposed agenda for approval;
 - b. A consent agenda which includes the minutes of the previous board meeting, as well as the minutes of any other committee meetings or relevant subsidiaries which took place since the previous board meeting;
 - c. The report of the executive committee for the month, which outlines the progress the UTSU has made towards achieving its strategic objectives, along with any other important updates, since the previous meeting;
 - d. Any other required appendices, depending on the month and meeting; and
 - e. These shall be delivered by the VP, Finance and Operations, with the exception of the first meeting's package, which will be delivered by the President
5. For Special Meetings of the Board of Directors, the meeting package which provides all the necessary information shall be sent as soon as possible following notice. If possible, the meeting package shall be sent alongside notice for purposes of transparency.
 - a. Packages for special meetings are entirely subject to the needs of the meeting, and may not necessarily include a consent agenda or executive report.

6. The 'meeting package deadline' and 'notice deadline' represent two separate obligations. Members of the board must be notified about a meeting when notice is sent, in a manner consistent with Article 3, Section 5 of the Bylaws.

SPEAKING RIGHTS & TURNS TO SPEAK

7. Directors shall have three (3) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
8. Directors shall be granted time as needed to present an item if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Directors shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
 - a. When non-Directors offer relevant information to a discussion or are requested to give a presentation or commentary to the Board, they shall be granted the right to speak and engage with the Board at the discretion of the Speaker.
 - b. Procedure surrounding the granting of speaking privileges shall be conducted in a manner that is minimally intrusive to the flow of a meeting, and with the necessary consent of the Board.
 - c. Generally, unless the presence of a non-Director is material to the substance of a meeting, speaking rights shall be reserved for members of the Board.
9. When members of the executive committee provide their reports at regular meetings, they shall be granted time as needed to provide their reports.

PRESS, MEDIA, RECORDING & LIVE-STREAMING

10. Members of the media and campus press are welcomed at meetings of the Board, however all guests are required to seek recognition and announce their intentions prior to conducting any form of recording or photographing at meetings of the Board.
11. Meetings of the Board may be filmed, recorded, and/or live-streamed only by members of the media or with the consent of the Board. If such actions are taken without the consent of the Board, the Board may act appropriately to relocate or clear the space.
12. Guests who take photo, video, or audio recordings at meetings of the Board must provide a form of contact information so that those present can request that their likeness not be reproduced.

IN-CAMERA / EXECUTIVE SESSION

13. A majority vote of the Board of Directors may, at any point, vote to move in-camera or ex-camera, meaning to move in or out of a closed and confidential executive session.
14. Only members of the Board of Directors shall be entitled to remain present during meetings held in executive session. Others may be granted permission to remain with the express consent of the assembly, obtained in a manner determined by the Speaker.

MEETINGS HELD ELECTRONICALLY

15. Meetings may be held electronically in accordance with Article 6 of the Bylaws.

	AREA	SRO	Special Rules of Order	
	POLICY	002	Meetings of Standing Committees	
	OWNERS	Board of Directors, Governance Committee		
	AFFECTS	Meetings of the Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		21 Feb 2023	REVIEWED	N/A
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

SRO-002 | Committees of the Board

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the Special Rules of Order which govern meetings of the UTSU's Standing Committees, which are defined in Article 8 of the Bylaws.
2. These Special Rules of Order are meant to be used in conjunction with the most recent version of the UTSU's parliamentary authority, *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*.

NOTICE & MEETINGS

3. Unless otherwise defined in the terms of reference of an individual committee, notice shall be given to members of a committee, as well as the Secretary of the UTSU, no later than seventy-two (72) hours prior to the date and time in which a meeting is to be called.
4. After notice is given but no later than twenty-four (24) hours prior to a meeting, an agenda which includes any required supporting materials must be sent to recipients for review.

RIGHTS, ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

5. The Secretary of the UTSU shall be the steward for all committees of the Board, and shall ensure that meetings are being scheduled, held, recorded, and minuted in a way which fulfils the obligations the UTSU has to be accountable to its members.
6. The Committee Chair and the Committee Secretary of each committee shall work with the Secretary of the UTSU to ensure that their committee is always fully compliant and that meetings are being sufficiently held and minuted.
 - a. Consistent with the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act*, no Director may vote on behalf of another Director at any meeting of Directors. No proxies.
 - b. Consistent with the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act*, no person who is not a Director may be a voting member of a committee of the Board.
7. If a committee cannot form a one (1) quorate meeting, the management committee may execute the role of that committee until a quorate meeting is formed by its respective chair. If the management committee is unable to do so, the executive committee may execute the role.

IN-CAMERA / EXECUTIVE SESSION

8. A majority vote of a committee may, at any point, vote to move in-camera or ex-camera, meaning to move in or out of a closed and confidential executive session.
9. Only members of a committee shall be entitled to remain present during meetings held in executive session. Others may be granted permission to remain with the unanimous consent of a committee.

MEETINGS HELD ELECTRONICALLY

10. Meetings may be held electronically in accordance with Article 6 of the Bylaws.

TERMS OF REFERENCE

11. Terms of reference are extra to the UTSU's parliamentary authority, and specifically enable committees to conduct themselves in ways which are more informal and appropriate for the environment, as opposed to more formal board meetings.
12. Committees shall adopt and maintain a terms of reference, which follows a template provided by the Governance Committee, and accomplishes the following objectives:
 - a. Sets a detailed mandate for the committee in a manner consistent with Article 8 of the Bylaws, empowering the committee to assume certain responsibilities;
 - b. Defines the roles and responsibilities of the Committee Chair and Committee Secretary, and outlines the procedure in which the roles are to be appointed if they are not already prescribed within the terms of reference or Bylaws;
 - c. Outlines the methods in which meetings are to be called, held, and minuted;
 - d. Outlines the rules surrounding speaking rights, speaking turns, and the right for those who are not committee members to be present or speak at a meeting;
 - e. Outlines any procedures or other considerations as appropriate for holding meetings electronically, in open or closed session, or in executive session; and
 - f. Identifies and defines any other unique elements of the operations of a given committee which may otherwise be incompatible with *Robert's Rules*.

RELEVANT RULES, LAWS & AUTHORITIES

13. At times, the mandate of a given committee may be necessarily affected by another governing document, precedent, or authority. In situations where other relevant rules or expectations apply, the Committee Chair and Committee Secretary shall work with the Secretary of the UTSU to ensure that their committee is meeting its obligations.

	AREA	SRO	Standing Rules	
	POLICY	003	Membership Meetings	
	OWNERS	Board of Directors		
	AFFECTS	Meetings of the Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		21 Feb 2023	REVIEWED	N/A
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

SRO-003 | Membership Meetings

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. These standing rules outline additional ways in which membership meetings at the UTSU are to be governed, in a manner consistent with Article 5 of the Bylaws.
2. These standing rules are meant to be used in conjunction with the most recent version of the UTSU's parliamentary authority, *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*.
3. Article 5, Section 3 of the Bylaws governs quorum at membership meetings.
4. Article 5, Section 4 of the Bylaws governs absentee voting at membership meetings.

REGULAR MEMBERSHIP MEETINGS

5. Article 5, Section 1.1 of the Bylaws governs Annual General Meetings.
6. Article 5, Section 1.2 of the Bylaws governs Spring General Meetings.

STANDING RULES FOR REGULAR MEMBERSHIP MEETINGS

7. Unless otherwise amended or substituted by the Board of Directors, the Standing Rules for Regular Membership Meetings of the UTSU shall be the following:
 - a. The UTSU President shall be empowered to appoint:
 - i. a committee of three, which includes the UTSU President, responsible for reviewing and approving the meeting minutes after the meeting;
 - ii. a Credentials Committee, to verify the identity of all delegates; and
 - iii. other committees as necessary to conduct the meeting.
 - b. The UTSU Speaker shall preside. The UTSU Speaker may appoint a Chair pro tempore when necessary and may vary the adopted program as necessary.
 - c. If RSVP details have been provided beforehand by the UTSU, all participants who are attending will have registered using the RSVP details provided. All members who registered shall be credentialed by the Credentials Committee prior to the meeting being called to order. Members who have not registered

and been credentialed by the Credentials Committee prior to the meeting being called to order shall not be admitted to the meeting.

- d. The quorum shall be that which is established by Article 5 of the Bylaws.
- e. Only members of UTSU shall be entitled to make motions, debate, and vote.
- f. No member shall speak more than twice to a question, nor longer than two (2) minutes, without the consent of the assembly.
- g. During question period for executives and officers, all members shall be permitted to ask no more than two questions. No member shall speak longer than two (2) minutes in asking a question or providing a response.
- h. The presiding officer may recognize UTSU Officers and/or UTSU staff to provide factual background information prior to an item on the adopted order of business; the aforementioned shall not be considered debate, nor shall it be used to debate an item.
- i. Each presentation and/or report shall not exceed 15 minutes in total length, inclusive of all questions and answers unless a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the assembly orders otherwise.
- j. Members may only seek the floor when it is in order to do so and prompted by the presiding officer. Members may not interrupt, even by a motion otherwise in order when another has the floor under the parliamentary authority. Members who interrupt are considered to be violating the decorum of the meeting.
- k. All motions shall be processed by unanimous consent unless otherwise ordered by the assembly or the presiding officer; any debate or the application of any motions to a question shall only be upon the request of five (5) UTSU members; if less than five (5) UTSU members provide a request, the motion shall be adopted by unanimous consent.
- l. Votes that are required to be by ballot will be conducted using a system that anonymizes the votes cast.
- m. All individuals who contravene the rules of the UTSU may be removed from the meeting following a vote of the assembly, as per the parliamentary authority, or by the ruling of the presiding officer.
- n. When a meeting is to be held electronically, the following rules shall apply:
 - i. Members must display their first and last names on their screens at all times, and when addressing the chair, a member shall give their name.
 - ii. Officers, staff, and the presiding officer may display their titles.
 - iii. All main motions shall be displayed using a shared screen option or typed into a chat pod at the time the motion is made.
 - iv. Members may seek recognition by the presiding officer by using the "raise hand" feature provided at a virtual meeting. Whenever a member has been recognized, the list of those who raised hands will be cleared.

- v. A show of hands using the “raise hand” feature provided at a virtual meeting shall be used for voting except for unanimous consent and votes by ballot.
- vi. Members participating in the electronic meeting shall be responsible for the functionality of their own equipment. If a Member's equipment causes a hindrance to the meeting, the presiding officer, or an individual acting under the direction of the presiding officer, shall disable or disconnect the distracting component. A member's inability to participate in the meeting, in any function whatsoever, if caused by the member's equipment or connection, shall not invalidate the meeting or any of its proceedings.
- vii. Chat boxes shall be for official/technical meeting use. Commentary and/or debate shall not be allowed in the chat. Continued efforts to do so are a violation of decorum.

SPECIAL MEMBERSHIP MEETINGS

- 8. Article 5, Section 2 of the Bylaws provides that a written request to the Board of at least 100 members shall be required before a Special Membership Meeting may be called.
 - a. The form of written request shall be in the form of a petition, which includes:
 - i. The purpose of the meeting to be called;
 - ii. The specific business that is to be considered at the meeting;
 - iii. The date and time the meeting is requested to be called;
 - b. Petitions which call for a Special Membership Meeting must collect the following from eligible members of the association who sign the petition:
 - i. Full legal name, with the option to add a preferred name;
 - ii. University of Toronto student number;
 - iii. University of Toronto email address;
 - iv. Phone number.
- 9. Once a petition has successfully fulfilled all of its requirements under this policy, the Board of Directors shall be responsible for ensuring that the members have received prior and informed notice according to the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act*.

STANDING RULES FOR SPECIAL MEMBERSHIP MEETINGS

- 10. Following the legitimate written request of at least 100 members, the Board of Directors shall meet to adopt a set of Standing Rules in addition to calling the Special Membership Meeting itself, in a manner consistent with Article 2 of the Bylaws.

	AREA	SRO	Standing and Special Rules of Order	
	POLICY	004	Board of Directors and Executive Changes	
	OWNERS	Board of Directors, People and Culture Committee		
	AFFECTS	Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		March 15, 2026	REVIEWED	March 15, 2026
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

SRO-004 | Board of Directors and Executive Changes

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines how the UTSU will handle changes in Board membership, as well as Executive team membership, during a given term.
2. This policy applies to all Directors and the elected Executive positions, including Elected Officer positions.

POLICY

3. Each year, an Executive team, including Elected Officers, is elected to lead the UTSU with the support of the Board of Directors. Each Executive member and Director is expected to serve in their position for the fiscal year, May 1 to April 30.
4. During the course of UTSU's fiscal year, a Director or Executive member may not be able to fulfil their duties in extreme circumstances. This policy outlines how the UTSU will proceed if one of these circumstances should occur.

PROCEDURE

5. Director
 - a. In the event a Director must resign from their position, Article 3, Section 9 of the UTSU bylaws will be followed.
 - b. In the event a Director is found to be insufficiently fulfilling their role, this will be brought to the People and Culture Committee for review. The People and Culture (P&C) Committee must conduct an investigation to determine whether the Director in question can complete their duties moving forward. The P&C Committee will consult with UTSU's legal counsel and work with the Director in question to provide resources such that the Director can complete their term. If the Director still cannot perform their duties, they will resign from their position.
 - c. Attendance at Board Meetings is mandatory. Directors shall make every effort to attend and participate in meetings throughout their term. In the event a Director is unable to attend 3 consecutive meetings or more, this will be

considered as part of the investigation conducted in section b above when examining the removal of a Director. In the event a Director only attends a portion of a meeting, the P&C Committee shall determine whether the attendance was insufficient and be deemed non-attendance.

6. Elected Officer vacancies are discussed in the Article 2, Section 4 of the UTSU Bylaws. The P&C committee will review all findings and bring to Board for decision
7. Elected Executive, other than Elected Officers
 - a. In the event an Elected Executive, except the Elected Officers, must resign from their position, the President will assume the interim role for the balance of the term.
 - b. In the event an Elected Executive is found to be insufficiently fulfilling their role, this will be brought to the P&C Committee. The UTSU Director of People & Culture will conduct an investigation to determine whether the Elected Executive in question can complete their duties moving forward. The results of the investigation, as well as a recommendation from the UTSU's legal counsel will be brought to the Board of Directors, confidentially, for a final decision.

Any changes to the Board composition would be discussed in an emergency board meeting in order to respect the privacy of the individual.

	AREA	SRO	Standing and Special Rules of Order	
	POLICY	005	Board of Directors' Compensation	
	OWNERS	Board of Directors		
	AFFECTS	Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		March 15, 2026	REVIEWED	March 15, 2026
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

SRO-005 | Board of Directors' Compensation

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the compensation to be paid to Directors, where applicable, during their term.
2. This policy applies to all Directors, except for the President and Vice President Finance and Operations. The President and Vice President Finance and Operations will be compensated based on position requirements and are not addressed in this policy.

POLICY

3. Each year, the UTSU Directors will be paid an honorarium upon completion of their annual term. This honorarium will be a small amount, paid in cash, as a token of recognition for their time and dedication during the year.
4. Directors will also receive a reasonable cell phone allowance each month of their term in recognition of the use of their personal devices for UTSU Board work.
5. Directors will be reimbursed for reasonable expenses incurred in the course of providing service to the UTSU Board. Any expenses for reimbursement will require supporting, itemized receipts and approval from the Vice President Finance and Operations.

PROCEDURE

6. The amount of the cell phone allowance and honorarium will be determined by the People and Culture Committee and reviewed annually for reasonableness. Any changes will take effect May 1st of the following fiscal year.

The UTSU will not be responsible for withholding or collecting any income tax or payroll related taxes with respect to payments made to Directors.

Operations & Finance Policies (OF)

Outlining the UTSU's financial and operational practices.

Not personnel policies. For the building policies and guidelines for the Student Commons building at 230 College St. please refer to the Student Commons Rules & Regulations.

	AREA	OF	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	001	UTSU Budgets & Financial Reporting
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Finance and Executive Committee, Management	

OF-001 | UTSU Budgets & Finances

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. This policy shall broadly govern the budgeting process, financial reporting, and broader financial powers and limitations of the UTSU.
 - a. From time to time, exceptions may be made on an ad hoc basis to the budget timeline if the UTSU becomes subject to new limitations, regulatory or otherwise, such as the optionalization of certain fees.
2. The UTSU Board of Directors, in conjunction with the Finance Committee and the Management Committee shall be responsible for providing oversight and direction to the budgets and finances of the UTSU.
3. The UTSU Board of Directors will ensure responsible stewardship of the organization's financial resources, ensuring financial decisions align with the mission of the UTSU.
4. There are 3 distinct groups responsible for the UTSU's finances. These groups and their scope are as follows:
 - a. Board of Directors – holds ultimate accountability for the UTSU's finances. Only the Board can approve the budget and financial statements of the UTSU. The Board may relay on a subset of Directors to complete more in depth review of the these items.
 - b. Finance Committee – the Finance Committee is made up of a subset of Board members. This group will review financial documents prepared by the Management Committee and team in detail in order to make a recommendation to the Board.
 - c. Management Committee – the management Committee is made up of the elected officers and the General Manager (GM)/Chief Administrative Officer (CAO). This group is responsible for preparing the budget, forecast, and other financial documents, based on the activities of the UTSU.

UTSU BUDGET PROCESS

Budget Preparation and Approval

5. The Vice-President, Finance & Operations and the (GM) / (CAO), shall prepare the Budget for review by the Finance Committee, to be presented to the Board thereafter
 - a. The Budget must be presented to the Finance Committee for review at least ten (10) days prior to the March/April BOD Meeting for the upcoming fiscal year.
 - b. The Vice-President, Finance & Operations and GM / CAO shall then jointly present the Budget to the Board, generally at the April Meeting.
 - c. When approving the Budget, the Board shall rely on the priorities of the organization and the actuals for the previous year's chart of accounts, prepared by the Vice-President, Finance & Operations and GM / CAO. The budget will consider the planning priorities of the Board of Directors and maintain the financial health of the UTSU, ensuring the organization is not put in the position of economic insecurity.
6. Until the Budget is approved, the Vice-President Finance & Operations and the GM/CAO are authorized to spend up to twenty five percent (25%) of the previous fiscal year's budget in order to ensure continued operation of the UTSU.

Forecast Preparation and Approval

7. The Vice-President Finance & Operations and the GM/CAO, shall prepare a Forecast for review by the Finance Committee no later than December. If there are no substantive changes from the original budget approved by the Board of Directors, the Finance Committee may approve the forecast. The decision to present the forecast to the Board lies with the Finance Committee.
8. When approving the Forecast, the Finance Committee shall rely on:
 - a. The Budget;
 - b. The individual budgets proposed by the various spending units;
 - c. The audited financial statements approved at the Annual General Meeting;
 - d. The profit and loss statements for the first six months of the fiscal year; and
 - e. An updated assessment of the UTSU's expected revenues and expenses for the rest of the year.

Continued Reporting & Adjustment

9. The Vice-President, Finance & Operations and GM/CAO shall monitor the financial activities of the UTSU, and provide quarterly reports of financial activities to the Finance Committee.

10. From time to time, the Finance Committee may meet to discuss the financial standing of the UTSU, including monthly updates on financial activities.
11. Substantive changes to the budget, accommodating the changing needs of the organization, shall be made by resolution of the Board of Directors.
 - a. Reasonable spending overages may be made at the Finance Committee's discretion. Where an overage is required due a time-sensitive matter, the Management Committee may approve and report to the Finance Committee at the next meeting.

RECORD OF ACCOUNTS

12. The officers of the UTSU shall maintain a current chart of accounts of the UTSU, as per the current accounting standards of the organization. Any additions or deletions from the chart of accounts will be approved by the Financial Controller.
13. The Vice-President, Finance & Operations and GM/CAO shall be tasked with monitoring and maintaining the financial administration and internal controls of the UTSU. From time to time, the Finance Committee may meet to discuss the ways in which the UTSU's financial reporting and maintenance of internal controls are being executed.

	AREA	OF	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	002	Policy on Restricted Levies
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Board, Finance and Executive Committee, Management	

OF-002 | Restricted Fees & Levies

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. This policy governs the use and collection of restricted fees & levies by the UTSU.

ADMINISTRATION FEE REVENUE POLICY

Health Plan Fee

2. The UTSU collects a refundable Health Plan Fee from every member. The Board of Directors has the authority to increase the Health Plan Fee by up to 10% per year. The Health Plan is composed of the following:
 - a. The Health Plan Premium, which is remitted to the Health and Dental Plan insurer;
 - b. The Health Plan Brokerage Fee, which is remitted to the Health and Dental Plan broker; and
 - c. The Health Plan Administration Fee, which is retained by the UTSU in order to administer the Health and Dental Plan

Dental Plan Fee

3. The UTSU collects a refundable Dental Plan Fee from every member. The Board of Directors has the authority to increase the Dental Plan Fee by up to 10% per year. The Dental Plan Fee is composed of the following:
 - a. The Dental Plan Premium, which is remitted to the Health and Dental Plan insurer;
 - b. The Dental Plan Brokerage Fee, which is remitted to the Health and Dental Plan broker; and
 - c. The Dental Plan Administration Fee, which is retained by the UTSU in order to administer the Health and Dental Plan

Administration Fee Revenue - Health Plan and Dental Plan

4. "Health and Dental Plan Administration Fee Revenue" refers to all Health Plan Administration Fees and Dental Plan Administration Fees collected by the UTSU. In a given year, the Health and Dental Plan Administration Fee Revenue shall be distributed as follows:
 - a. A minimum of \$16 per student, taking into account any applicable CPI increases year over year, will be transferred to the Operating Budget.
 - b. The remainder of the funds shall be allocated at the discretion of the Board. Possible allocations include but are not limited to:
 - i. The Health and Dental Plan Reserve Fund
 - ii. The Operating Budget

ACCESSIBILITY FEES POLICY

5. The UTSU collects the non-refundable Accessibility Resource Fund (ARF) fee from all members at the St. George Campus. The fee is \$0.50 per session and cannot be increased without a referendum. It will expire at the end of the Spring 2027 session.
6. The UTSU collects the non-refundable Wheelchair Accessibility Fund (WAF) fee from all members. The fee is \$1.00 per session and cannot be increased without referendum. It is permanent.

Use of ARF Fee

7. The ARF levy may only be used to make UTSU events, services, and capital projects accessible to members with disabilities. The fee may not be used to compensate employees of the UTSU.

Use of WAF Fee

8. The WAF Levy may only be used to make UTSU events, services, and capital projects permanently accessible to members with mobility-impairment disabilities. It may not be used to compensate employees of the UTSU.

Authorization

9. Use of the ARF and WAF levy must be explicitly approved by the Board of Directors.

Consultation

10. The UTSU will, to the greatest extent possible, consult on an ongoing basis with members with disabilities to ensure accessibility of its events, services, and capital projects.

OTHER LEVIES

11. The UTSU collects other refundable special program levies from all members of the St. George Campus. Changes to these levy amounts only occur through referenda. The table below outlines the expenses allowable under these special program levies and the spending approval limits.

Special Program Levy	Allowable Expenses	Spending Approval Requirement
Community Housing and Employment Support Services (CHESS)	- Activities that support students in finding employment while in school or in preparation for graduation - Activities that support students in finding housing or dealing with current housing situations (e.g. landlord disputes) - Investments in technology to aid students who require housing and employment support	See Financial Approval and Procurement Policy for approval requirements. These requirements are in place to ensure levy fund are being used for the intended purpose.
Dollar for Daycare	- Reimbursement to students for childcare costs - Expenses related to supporting students with household goods (e.g. through the Family Cupboard)	
Orientation	- Costs incurred to provide incoming students with an orientation to the University of Toronto (UofT) and the UTSU. These costs can include, but are not limited to, food, entertainment, space rentals, etc.	
Radical Roots	- Activities to address food insecurity amongst the UofT student population	

	- Providing students with direct access to food	
Student Refugee	- Activities supporting student refugees in the UofT student community - Direct sponsorship of a refugee student to attend UofT (including financial support for living expenses)	
Student Aid	- Direct financial support for students through an application process	Student Aid and Scholarship Committee review and approval

With respect to all levies in the chart above (section 11), the Board of Directors may, on a case by case basis, approve the use of funds outside of the allowable expenses.

	AREA	OF	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	003	Health & Dental Plan Policy
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	(ALL)	

OF-003 | Health and Dental Plan

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. The University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) Health Plan was introduced by a student referendum in 1987. It is mandatory for all future students to participate unless they have coverage under an alternative private or government plan in addition to their basic provincial plan. It is designed to cover expenses not paid by the basic provincial plans.
2. The UTSU Dental Plan was introduced in 1998 by student referendum; however, participation is not mandatory.
3. This policy provides an outline of how the plans will be administered, and to guide future elected student leaders when making decisions affecting plan structure.

POLICY

Eligibility

4. The UTSU Health and Dental Plans are offered to all full-time undergraduate students who have paid the UTSU incidental fees with their tuition fees.
5. Full-time status requirements are determined by a student members' college or faculty.
6. Students are automatically enrolled in the UTSU Health and Dental Plan following each year's opt-out/enrolment period.

Eligibility Restrictions

7. Students who register and remain a full-time undergraduate during the fall and winter sessions are automatically eligible for coverage from 1 September until 31 August of that year.
8. Students who register in classes in the winter session only and who were not enrolled during the previous fall session are automatically eligible for coverage from 1 January until 31 August of that year.

9. Students who register in classes in the fall session are only eligible for coverage from 1 September until 31 December of that year.
10. Students who initially register as a full-time undergraduate in the fall or winter sessions, but who become part-time by dropping courses before the deadline to receive a 100 percent refund of the incidental fees are not eligible for coverage.
11. Students who cancel their academic registration during the period in which fees are refunded 50 per cent will be removed from the plan henceforth. In the event that a student has opted out of the plans prior to cancelling their registration, such students will be refunded only the amount of premium (50 per cent) collected by the University of Toronto on behalf of the UTSU
12. Co-op students who are currently on a work term are considered by the University of Toronto to be full-time for academic purposes, but are not charged incidental fees. Therefore, they will not be automatically enrolled in the plans. Co-op students on a work term, however, will have the option of self-enrolling provided this is done prior to the opt-out/enrolment deadline. In order to self-enrol, affected students will also have to pay the UTSU society fees.
13. Co-op students enrolled in a full-time course load will automatically be enrolled in the plans for the duration of that session.
14. Students that are classified by the Ontario Student Assistance Program (OSAP) as having a disability for the purpose of receiving government financial assistance do not retain this classification as it relates to the incidental fees charged by the University of Toronto. In this regard, the university makes no distinction due to disability, but rather assesses each student based on the number of courses they are enrolled in. As a result, many students with disabilities will not have adequate extended health and dental coverage to meet their needs. Students on the St. George Campus with disabilities (as recognized by Accessibility Services) who are otherwise ineligible for the plan will therefore have the option of self-enrolling in the plans provided this is done prior to the opt-out deadline. In order to self-enrol, affected students will also have to pay the UTSU society fees.

Confidentiality

15. All student information provided to the UTSU by the University of Toronto will be used solely for its intended purpose and will be accessible only by the President, the Vice-President, Finance & Operations, and the General Manager.

Consent

16. The UTSU is not responsible to the parents/guardians of full-time undergraduate students attending the University of Toronto. While staff are able to assist parents/guardians with general inquiries about the benefits, costs, deadlines, and claim forms, we are not obligated to answer specific questions about a specific student's claims history, opt-out record, policy identification codes, or student records.

17. Consent to provide information to parents/guardians may be granted under extenuating or health-related circumstances, however, such consent must be submitted in writing to the Health Plan Administrator who, in conjunction with representatives of the University of Toronto, will take appropriate measures relating to information-sharing.

Opting Out

18. Any full-time undergraduate student who has extended health coverage may opt-out of the health plan during the predetermined period designated by the UTSU.
19. Students must provide proof of alternative extended health coverage in order for their opt-out to be processed. Please note that OHIP and UHIP are not considered extended health plans.
20. Any full-time undergraduate student may opt-out of the dental plan during the pre-determined period designated by the UTSU. There is no requirement for students who wish to opt-out of the dental plan to have alternative dental coverage.

Deadlines

21. All students must opt-out of, or enroll into, the health and/or dental plans during the pre-determined periods specified by the UTSU. The UTSU will make every effort to publicize the deadlines. There are no exceptions to these deadlines except for medical or family emergencies, extenuating circumstances, or administrative errors. Students who believe they have a valid excuse for missing the opt-out/enrollment deadline must submit a letter explaining the circumstances with supporting documentation to the Health Plan Administrator.
22. All decisions regarding late opt-out applications will be made on a case-by-case basis. Only students who have paid the UTSU society fees and who have not attempted to file any claims will be considered.
23. The Services Committee, with the guidance of the Chief Administrative Officer, will make all decisions regarding late opt out applications.
 - a. They will consider factors like financial need in the decision making process.
24. Membership lists provided by the University are frequently incomplete due to students changing their full-time/part-time status and academic appeals. If, as a result of an incomplete membership list, a student who should have been enrolled in the plan is not enrolled, the UTSU shall attempt to accommodate the student provided that the UTSU can confirm the appropriate fees were paid.

Re-Enrollment

25. Students who lose their alternative coverage because a parent/guardian or spouse loses their job, or because they no longer qualify for coverage due to age restrictions, will be allowed to join the health and dental plans within thirty (30) days of losing their alternative coverage.
26. Affected students must submit a letter from the previous insurer/employer/administrator of the plan stating when and why their insurance was terminated. The letter should also include student number and contact information.

27. Please note that re-enrolment into one of either the health or dental plan is not possible. Students requesting re-enrolment will be charged for both the health and dental plan. Coverage will take effect on the day the alternative coverage was terminated.

	AREA	OFP	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	004	Internal Control Policy
	OWNERS	Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Board, Finance and Executive Committees, Management	

OF-004 | Internal Control Policy

PREAMBLE

1. The Students' Administrative Council (SAC) of the University of Toronto, operating as the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU), was incorporated on April 20, 1977 under the *Canada Business Corporations Act* as a non-profit corporation without share capital for the purpose of improving the quality of campus life, and services for the University of Toronto student body and to represent its member students in areas of common interest.
2. The University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) is entrusted with resources from member levies and other funding sources. UTSU has implemented a strong system of internal controls to focus on the efficient oversight of finance and operations accountability. With adherence to the UTSU by-laws, this policy further builds the proper stewardship of funds by providing guidelines and procedures for effective management of all UTSU funds.
3. UTSU is committed to setting up internal controls to act as checks and balances to:
 - a. Increase operational, and fiscal responsibility to help the UTSU meet its mission
 - b. Provides accurate financial data and reports
 - c. Safeguard assets of the organization and minimize risks
 - d. Comply with all applicable laws, regulations, policies, procedures, and practices
4. The UTSU Fiscal Year is the period beginning on May 1 of a given calendar year and ending on April 30 of the following calendar year.

SCOPE

5. This Internal Control Policy sets out responsibilities of staff who have access to funds, particularly to those who serve as Signing Officers and oversee fiscal management.
6. Under the general oversight of the UTSU Board of Directors (BOD), the President, the Vice-President Finance and Operations (VPFO), the Chief Administrative Officer/General Manager (CAO/GM), the Director of People & Culture, and the Financial Controller form a multi-functional support services team to oversee internal control/financial stewardship and human resource management for the organization.
7. Each UTSU employee is expected to act in a fiscally responsible manner, safeguarding resources against waste, loss, unauthorized use, and misappropriation. All staff share a

responsibility to understand and comply with UTSU internal control policies and procedures.

POLICY

8. The Board of Directors ensures that UTSU is in compliance with all applicable financial legislation, by-laws, regulations and Canadian accounting standards for not-for-profit organizations as established by the Accounting Standards Board (AcSB) and the Public Sector Accounting Board (PSAB).
9. Financial operations of the organization are administered by the Management Committee and Executive Committee subject to approval by the BOD. Pursuant to the *Canadian Income Tax Act*, the UTSU is classified as a not-for-profit organization and, as such, is not subject to income tax.
10. UTSU Board members are volunteers who serve as fiduciaries of the organization. By becoming a fiduciary of the UTSU, directors assume certain responsibilities, including assuming some liability for decisions the UTSU makes, including its financial decisions and any legal proceedings it enters.
11. A Signing Officer is a designated full-time staff member vested with the authority to sign official documents, mainly in respect to payments, purchases, and contracts. The signing officers of the UTSU are the:
 - a. President
 - b. Vice President, Finance and Operations
 - c. CAO/GM
12. In the event of a prolonged absence of a Signing Officer, responsibility for signing will lie with the remaining Signing Officers. Signing authority may be extended to another individual on a temporary basis to meet operational needs by submission of a request in writing to the UTSU BOD.
13. UTSU has established key successful practices/guidelines to establish internal control:
 - a. **Promotion of Internal Control Policies:** UTSU promotes a culture that embraces effective internal control policies with organization-wide effort to establish, implement, and maintain internal controls with frequent internal reviews.
 - b. **Transparency and Public Disclosure:** UTSU supports timely reporting using standard templates and disclosure of program and functional expenditures.
 - c. **Independent Audit:** Financial records shall be audited on an annual basis by a chartered accountant firm duly licensed in the Province of Ontario as a guarantee that proper accounting standards are being met by the organization. Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of its financial statements in accordance with Canadian accounting standards for not-for-profit organizations, per the *Canadian Not-For-Profit Corporations Act (CNCA)*. An independent auditor shall be appointed by motion at the Annual General Meeting (AGM). Audited statements showing the actual financial

position of the UTSU for two fiscal years are prepared/shared at a BOD meeting with any insights an independent auditor has provided.

- d. **Risk Assessment:** UTSU maintains a risk-based system of controls over financial management ensuring that prompt corrective action is taken when issues are identified. This involves identifying areas in which the greatest threat or risk for inaccuracies or loss exist and working to rectify the biggest issues first.
- e. **Segregation of Duties:** UTSU divides financial responsibilities and establishes clear accountabilities so that all aspects of a financial transaction do not fall to one employee only. Where it is not possible to segregate duties, compensating controls of review and approval are in effect to ensure financial accuracy and integrity.
- f. **Finance Committee:** UTSU has an established Finance Committee, which includes the President, VPFO, CAO/GM, that reports to the UTSU BOD as an additional layer of oversight to make certain the organization is operating with the financial resources it needs.
 - i. The Finance Committee shall ensure that those charged with the management of the organization are administering financial processes and internal controls in a manner which ensures the financial longevity, integrity, and auditability of the corporation.
 - ii. The Finance Committee shall meet to review the audited financial statements and recommend them to the Board for adoption before they are sent to the members.
 - iii. The audited financial statements of the organization shall be presented in an appropriate location on the website, and in a conspicuous and obvious manner.
- g. **Dedicated Financial Oversight:** The CAO / GM provides the Finance Committee with all fundamental financial statements, including a quarterly balance sheet, statements of revenue and expenses. To assist with this process, the Finance Department prepares monthly bank reconciliations, processes payables (CRA remittances, WSIB, utilities, reimbursement of expenses), processes accounts receivable, monitors daily bank balance. The Financial Controller prepares quarterly financial statements to review with the CAO/GM in preparation for presentation to the Finance Committee.
- h. **Monitoring/Reviewing:** The system of internal control is periodically reviewed by the Management Committee to ensure compliance with local, provincial and federal laws.
- i. **Environmental Controls:** controls put in place by UTSU management include:
 - i. **Approval Levels:** two signatures are required to authorize financial transactions, limiting the authority to spend or disburse UTSU funds. One signature must be the CAO / GM. Several levels of approval are also required to approve decisions that have a monetary effect, in accordance with the Procurement Policy, limiting individual responsibility for serious organizational decisions. Each authorized person has the opportunity to question decisions and veto, reducing errors and organizational liability.

- ii. **Access Levels:** access to confidential information is restricted to employees with similar access levels for the coordination of payroll, benefits and other employee accommodations.
- iii. **Leveraging Commercial Technology:** UTSU invests in commercial technology and systems to safeguard information under UTSU control from unauthorized access.
- iv. **Computer Logins and Passwords:** Unique login/passwords are used to protect computer systems and databases which contain sensitive company financial and proprietary data.
- v. **Financial Policies:** financial policy and procedures have been implemented to clearly communicate responsibilities and expectations. The Management Team works in-conjunction with the Executive Committee to draft and update policies before presentation to UTSU's BOD for approval.

PROCEDURE

References and Related Documents

- 14. The Board of Directors shall provide guidance, interpretation, and input to the CAO/ GM relating to financial processes governed by the following legislation and regulations:
 - a. Canadian accounting standards for not-for-profit organizations, AcSB, and PSAB requirements
 - b. Federal and Provincial tax legislation and requirements
 - c. *Employment Standards Act* (ESA)
 - d. *Canadian Not-for-Profit Corporations Act* (CNCA)
 - e. UTSU By-laws, policies and related procedures
 - f. *Income Tax Act*
- 15. The Board of Directors may use these resources to assist in the interpretation of the above:
 - a. Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) interpretations and guidelines
 - b. External and internal auditor findings and recommendations
 - c. Canadian Payroll Association
 - d. Chartered Professional Accountants of Canada

Safeguards

- 16. UTSU ensures the security of physical assets and safeguards records, protecting against threats to security or the integrity of records, and guards against unauthorized access, use, or fraud. The following safeguards outline how financial resources will be handled:
 - a. Two (2) authorized officers' signatures on all cheques prepared by the organization. Where funds are distributed electronically (via direct deposit), UTSU's banking system will be set to require two (2) approvers. The authorized

individuals to process bank payments are the President, VPFO, CAO/GM and Financial Controller.

- b. Invoices will be reviewed by signing officers
- c. The CAO/GM or Director, People & Culture will review all payroll entries before processing
- d. Deposits to the bank will be made in a timely manner.
- e. Accurate/complete documentation of all BOD and Finance Committee meetings are maintained in the form of minutes.
- f. Securities and back-up of all finance accounts will be placed in an access-controlled system.
- g. A cash receipt journal is to be kept by the Finance Department that identifies the date funds are received, the source of funds, the amount of the funds, the cheque number (if a cheque) and initials of the person who received the funds.
- h. Receipts will be issued for all payments received by either cash or cheque as requested.

Books and Records - Financial Reporting

- 17. A chart of accounts will be maintained in order to indicate each item for which a ledger account is to be maintained. The Finance Committee, in collaboration with the Vice-President, Finance & Operations and the CAO/GM, will be responsible for ensuring the organization's chart of accounts is current and reflective of the organizational needs.
- 18. The UTSU Finance Department shall create and maintain all financial books and records.
- 19. Quarterly financial reports will be prepared by the UTSU Finance Department, in conjunction with the CAO/GM in advance of the corresponding months' Board Meeting.
- 20. Annual financial reports will be produced on an annual basis within 45 days of the end of the financial year. The reports will include an Annual Profit and Loss Statement showing income and expenses by budget category; and End of Year Balance Sheet showing all organizational assets and liabilities as of the last day of the fiscal year.

Publication of Audited Statements

- 21. Annual audited statements of the organization shall be made available to any member who requests the same. The annual audited statements shall be posted on the UTSU website.

Budgeting Process

- 22. The UTSU operating budget will be developed by the VPFO, CAO/GM and Finance Committee and approved by the Board of Director, per the guidelines of the UTSU Budgets and Finances Policy.

Inventory-Capital Asset Management

23. The UTSU will maintain accurate capital asset inventory records. The CAO and the Director of Operations will be responsible for the management of all capital assets. Inventory records will provide an accurate description of the item, the date purchased and the purchase price.

	AREA	OFP	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	005	Privacy Policy
	OWNERS	Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Board, Finance and Executive Committees, Management	

OF-005 | Privacy Policy

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. Privacy is a fundamental right, the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) is committed to protecting any personal information collected in its regular course of business. As well, the UTSU is committed to the protection of personal information collected by the UTSU website or other electronic interactions with the UTSU.
2. This policy has been developed in a manner consistent with Article 10 of the Bylaws, the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act*, and the *Employment Standards Act* (ESA).
3. This policy addresses the reasons why UTSU collects personal information, how we use it, how we keep it private, and which rules govern the retention, disclosure and disposal of personal information. It outlines an individual's rights with respect to their information.
4. This privacy policy is applicable to all members of the UTSU community which includes our Board of Directors, past and current employees, community partners, alumni, business contacts and those who participate in UTSU events, activities, programs and services.

DEFINITIONS

5. Common terms and legislation that may be referenced in regard to the protection of privacy/access to information, these are not legal definitions and are for reference only:
 - a. **Personal Information:** any information that identifies an individual. This includes information such as a name, address, IP address, telephone number, birth date, SIN, e-mail address, employment information and other confidential information.
 - b. **Record:** Any documentary material, regardless of medium, under the control of UTSU.
 - c. **Control:** records that are in the physical or digital possession of the UTSU are generally considered under its control.
 - d. **Privacy Act (R.S.C., 1985, c. P-21):** the law that sets out an individual's privacy rights during interactions with the federal government in Canada. It protects personal information that the federal government holds and the right to access/correct personal information. Applies to federal government institutions (i.e., CRA, etc.)

- e. **Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA):** Canadian law that governs how private-sector organizations collect, use and disclose personal information in the course of commercial business. Most not-for-profit and charity groups are exempt.
- f. **Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FIPPA):** provincial law that requires that the Ontario government protect the privacy of personal information existing in government records. It also gives individuals the right to request access to government-held information, including personal and general records. Applies to the provincial government, universities, colleges, hospitals and designated agencies.
- g. **Municipal Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (MFIPPA):** privacy law that applies to municipal public-sector corporations-metropolitan, district or regional municipality, local boards and commissions.

POLICY

- 6. As a proactive measure to safeguard personal information, and to be transparent and accountable for how it is used, UTSU has developed its privacy policy to comply with PIPEDA's principles:
 - a. **Principle 1 - Accountability:** UTSU is accountable to protect the personal information under its control. All UTSU staff members are responsible for compliance with this policy when handling personal information.
 - b. **Principle 2 - Identifying Purposes:** The purpose for which personal information is collected shall be identified by UTSU at the time the information is collected.
 - c. **Principle 3 - Consent:** UTSU will obtain meaningful consent for the collection, use and disclosure of personal information. UTSU will obtain consent when making significant changes to privacy practices, including the use of data for new purposes.
 - d. **Principle 4 - Limiting Collection:** UTSU will not collect personal information unless an individual chooses to use services or programs that require it. UTSU will limit its collection of personal information to only the information that is necessary.
 - e. **Principle 5 - Limiting Use, Disclosure & Retention:** Personal information will only be used for the purpose identified when collected and will not be disclosed without prior consent from UTSU. Information is only kept as long as needed to satisfy the purposes for which it was collected and will be retained only as long as needed.
 - f. **Principle 6 - Accuracy:** Every effort will be made to ensure that personal information is as complete, up to date, and as accurate as possible.
 - g. **Principle 7 - Safeguards:** UTSU will use up-to-date security protocols to ensure the integrity and confidentiality of UTSU systems and any personal information collected.

- h. **Principle 8 - Openness:** UTSU will make policies available in an easy to read format.
- i. **Principle 9 - Individual Access:** An individual may request access to personal information that the UTSU may have concerning them. This applies to full-time, part-time, and contract employees, as well as UTSU members.
- j. **Principle 10 - Provide Recourse:** UTSU may be contacted with concerns regarding our adherence to this privacy policy and keeping personal information secure.

Collection of Personal Information

- 7. UTSU only collects personal information for legitimate, limited and specific purposes. For instance, to carry out its day-to-day business, develop a better understanding of the needs of our membership, and to provide relevant programming and services. Personal information may be collected when filling out an application for programs or services such as financial aid, food programming, or participation in UTSU events and activities. UTSU may also indirectly collect personal information when personal information is shared during the hiring process or to facilitate the application for employment benefits. UTSU collects/receives information in the following ways:
 - a. Each undergraduate student enrolled at the St. George campus and students from certain faculties automatically become a member of the University of Toronto Students' Union. OVPS shares a register of members with UTSU and we become responsible for keeping this information private.
 - b. In other instances, members give us information, when they communicate with the UTSU, sign up to participate in events and activities, take part in elections, and participate in our programs and services. Employees share their information as well.

Use of Personal Information

- 8. UTSU uses and discloses personal information for the specified purpose for which it was collected. UTSU uses personal information to develop and provide services and programs, to contact and respond to individuals by email, telephone or messaging apps, to provide information by newsletters (unless a user has opted not to receive such information), and to provide the best possible standards of administration and communication to achieve our non-profit objectives. UTSU will request consent to use information in accordance with this policy and only use information for the purposes for which it was collected.
- 9. During the UTSU election period, nominated candidates choose to share certain personal information such as their name and platform. Information on candidates may be used on the UTSU website and voting form in order to ensure a fair democratic voting process. Voter information may be retained to maintain an accurate voter record. After an election, UTSU will post information on our newly elected representatives on our website to keep members informed of official election results.

Protection of Personal Information

10. UTSU takes precautions and uses commercially accepted technology as a means to safeguard personal information under our control, both online and offline.
11. Within reason, employees with similar access levels are expected to safeguard information that must be shared for the coordination of payroll, benefits and employee accommodations.

Sharing and Retention of Personal Information

12. UTSU does not disclose personal information to any third-party unless required to do so by law, subpoena, court order, or legal process, including to respond to any government or regulatory request.
13. UTSU will retain personal information only as long as necessary for the purpose(s) for which it was collected. Personal information will be kept secure and destroyed when no longer required. The Students' Union may also decide to archive some data for historic purposes.

Recourse

14. Any individual who feels their privacy has been compromised by UTSU, may submit a complaint to the General Manager of UTSU for investigation. Individuals who are given access to their personal information have the right to request correction of information where they believe there is an error or omission. If this request is refused, individuals may request that a statement of disagreement be attached to the information. A refusal to correct information or attach a statement of disagreement may be appealed to the UTSU Board.

Web Usage Data and Technology

15. UTSU collects and uses personal information to operate the UTSU website. Usage data is collected automatically and may include information such as a device's Internet Protocol address (e.i., IP address), browser type, browser version, pages visited, time and date of a visit, time spent on pages, and other diagnostic data.
16. UTSU may track website usage to determine what services are the most popular, and deliver customized content to our members and others who visit our website for information.
17. By using or accessing the UTSU website, users consent to allowing UTSU to collect, use, and share information as described herein.

Cookies/Tracking Technology

18. The UTSU website may use "cookies" or tracking technology to help personalize a user's online experience. Cookies are small text files that are transferred to a computer (or phone or tablet) to make interacting with a website faster and easier. A user may accept or decline cookies. Declining cookies may limit interactive features of the UTSU website.

Links to Other Websites

19. The UTSU website may contain links to other websites not operated by the UTSU. UTSU has no control over and assumes no responsibility for the content or practices of any third-party sites or services.

Social Media

20. UTSU interacts with its members and the public using third-party Social Media services (i.e., Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter, Youtube, WhatsApp, etc.). When interacting through Social Media, personal data that is already associated with a user's third-party account such as a name, email address, or activities associated with their account may be collected by UTSU. Social networking users are cautioned that many companies harvest sensitive data about individuals' activities, interests, and online behaviours.

Messaging/Online Chat

21. UTSU uses the Crisp platform via our website as an online chat app for member queries. Crisp safeguards personal data with a high level of security and has taken appropriate technical and security measures to protect personal data from unauthorized access.

Zoom Meetings

22. UTSU uses Zoom Video Communications, Inc. ("Zoom") for online meetings, which is specifically designed to provide encrypted video conferencing with in-meeting security.

Electronic Monitoring

23. Electronic Monitoring refers to monitoring and digitally managing assets that includes the use of fobs to access the Student Commons, the use of video surveillance or closed-circuit television (CCTV) either operated by U of T, or by UTSU directly, and other information technology that UTSU may use to monitor its digital and physical resources for the purpose of protecting, managing, and ensuring the security of resources and the safety of UTSU community members. Data on fob usage and CCTV recordings can only be accessed by authorized personnel.

PROCEDURE

Requesting Access to Personal Information

24. UTSU is committed to keeping all personal information secure, accurate, and private. Whether an individual visits our website, contacts us, participates in one of our programs or services, or attends an event, the UTSU is committed to protecting privacy rights and the personal information under our control. Each individual has the right to access their personal information held by the University of Toronto Students' Union, to do so:

- a. direct any request to view personal information should be put in writing and sent to the Privacy Officer by email at generalmanager@utsu.ca.
- b. upon receipt of a written request, UTSU will authenticate the identity of the individual making the request.
- c. UTSU will provide you with a summary of any personal information in our possession, a description of the way in which that information is being used, and a list of the individuals and organizations to whom that information has been disclosed.
- d. UTSU will make information available within 30 days or provide written notice where additional time is required to fulfill the request.

Challenging Compliance

25. Any inquiries, issues, or complaints regarding the UTSU Privacy Policy should be directed in writing to the Privacy Officer by email at generalmanager@utsu.ca.
26. In some situations, UTSU may not be able to provide access to certain personal information, for example, where disclosure would reveal personal information about another individual. UTSU may also be legally prevented from providing access to certain personal information.

CITATIONS & APPENDICES

[Privacy Act \(R.S.C., 1985, c. P-21\)](#)

[Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act \(PIPEDA\)](#)

[Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act \(FIPPA\)](#)

[Municipal Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act \(MFIPPA\)](#)
<https://www.utoronto.ca/privacy>

	AREA	OFP	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	006	Investment Policy
	OWNERS	Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Board, Finance and Executive Committees, Management	

OF-006 | Investment Policy

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. This Investment Policy lays out the principles that guide how and when the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) invests funds to align with UTSU's financial objectives. It shall guide both the review of existing investments and of any new investment opportunities so that they are handled in a responsible manner. The UTSU investment portfolio has the purpose of preserving assets while maximizing total rate of return. Investment assets are to be managed with diversification and minimal risk are permitted.
2. UTSU is a membership-based organization, who has a responsibility to act in the best interests of its members when considering and entering into investments.
3. The UTSU Board of Directors has ultimate responsibility and decision-making authority over UTSU's portfolio of assets and investments. The Board delegates some of its responsibilities with respect to the portfolio to both the Finance and Management Committees, with guidance and oversight provided by the Chief Administrative Officer/GM/ED.

POLICY

Board Objectives

4. The UTSU Board serve as fiduciaries of the organization, and therefore are expected to:
 - a. oversee performance of the UTSU asset and investment portfolio.
 - b. direct the Finance Committee, Management Committee and CAO/GM/ED on investment matters.
 - c. govern the UTSU's portfolio in accordance with relevant legislation and UTSU finance and operational policy, procedures, and by-laws.
 - d. maintain an understanding of regulatory requirements/constraints, attend training, and formulate recommendations regarding members' mandates.
 - e. review the Investment Policy and make appropriate changes on an annual basis.
 - f. participate in the selection and engagement of professional investment managers or financial advisors if required.

Finance Committee Objectives

5. The Finance Committee has as its objectives:
 - a. Exercising its fiduciary duty while achieving the best Return on Investments (ROI) within a tolerable risk profile; incorporating environmental, social responsibility, and governance (ESG) factors; making sound investment decisions in a prudent and effective manner.
 - b. Ensuring funds are sufficient to support cash flow requirements as they arise.
 - c. Responsibility for ensuring that the UTSU meets its financial reporting obligations under the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act* and all other relevant laws and authorities.
 - d. Responsibility for monitoring that the reserves and overall assets of the UTSU are being responsibly and effectively managed, and that assets are deployed in a manner consistent with agreements, policies, or other rules which may be enforced by any relevant authority, including the University of Toronto.
 - e. Assist the BOD in developing the UTSU Investment Policy and then review annually, proposing any recommended changes required, for approval by the Board of Directors.

Social Responsibility

6. Incorporating environmental, social responsibility, and governance (ESG) factors.
7. All investment activities must be made in a democratic, financially, socially, and environmentally responsible manner in support of services and programming that enhance student life and in compliance with all existing policies, bylaws, and legislation.
8. UTSU is committed to socially responsible investing and commits to not investing in companies that are inconsistent with UTSU mission and values. UTSU requests that our investment advisors follow these principles when suggesting possible investments

PROCEDURE

9. The Board of Directors may approve the deployment or transfer of assets by a vote of two-thirds (2/3) vote. Such approvals shall be minuted at a meeting of the board and shall specify the amount, explicit purpose, and other relevant details of the action.

Reporting and Accountability

10. The Finance Committee shall be collectively responsible for ensuring that the UTSU meets its financial reporting obligations under the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act* and all other relevant laws and authorities. The Finance Committee shall meet when necessary to ensure the organization remains in good financial health, identify and manage both risks and opportunities, and refer required actions to the Board.

11. While this Investment Policy is to be reviewed at least annually, additional review or changes may be warranted by:
 - a. a significant change to economic, political and social factors that changes the long-term trade-off between risk and reward of investments.
 - b. a significant change in the expected net cash flow of the fund or a significant shift of the financial risk tolerance of the UTSU.
 - c. deficiencies in the policy that emerge in its practical application or substantive modifications recommended to the Finance Committee by an investment manager.
 - d. relevant changes in legislation requiring a policy modification.

CITATIONS AND APPENDICES

[Trustee Act, Ontario](#)

	AREA	OF	Operations & Finance Policy	
	POLICY	007	Clubs Policy	
	OWNERS	Clubs and Societies Committee		
	AFFECTS	Clubs and Societies Committee, Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		March 15, 2026	REVIEWED	March 15, 2026
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

OF-007 | Clubs Policy

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) is committed to providing funding and support to registered clubs. Registered clubs may apply for funding and receive all other club services during the registration year. The registration year is the year in which registration is granted to a club, beginning on May 1st and ending April 30th of the following calendar year.
2. The Clubs and Societies Committee, a subset of the Board of Directors, are responsible for granting recognition to clubs and overseeing the funding paid by UTSU to recognized club.
3. This policy, in conjunction with the Clubs & Student Groups Handbook, outlines the role of the UTSU with respect to clubs on campus and the responsibilities of these organizations.

POLICY

4. The UTSU may, from time to time, provide support and non-monetary resources to clubs that are not registered, on a case-by-case basis.
5. Registered clubs receive a significant benefit of eligibility for UTSU club funding. Club funding is allocated by the Clubs and Societies Committee in accordance with the Clubs & Student Groups Handbook. All applications must be received prior to the deadlines set by the UTSU.
6. Registered clubs are required to follow the UTSU's Code of Conduct and Policies.

PROCEDURE

7. During the registration year the UTSU will open applications for club recognition. A recognized club is a student group that has been granted recognition by the University of Toronto's Student Life department. In addition, 50% of its members must be UTSU full-time undergraduate students and the UTSU must receive a valid constitution, membership list, and Policy & Procedure Agreement for the club. Full recognition criteria is outlined in the Clubs & Student Groups Handbook.

8. Each year, the funding application period will be posted on the UTSU website. Recognized clubs are invited to apply for funding in accordance with funding criteria detailed in the Clubs & Student Groups Handbook.

CITATIONS AND APPENDICES

University of Toronto Students' Union Code of Conduct

[Clubs & Student Groups Handbook](#)

	AREA	OF	Operations & Finance Policies
	POLICY	008	UTSU Financial Approval & Procurement
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Finance and Executive Committee, Management	

OF-008 | UTSU Financial Approval & Procurement

PURPOSE & SCOPE

- This policy shall broadly govern the financial approval and procurement processes of the UTSU.
 - From time to time, exceptions may be made on an ad hoc basis to the procurement process if the UTSU becomes subject to new limitations, regulatory or otherwise. Any exceptions will be summarized and presented to the Board of Directors.
- The UTSU Board of Directors, in conjunction with the Finance Committee and the Management Committee shall be responsible for providing oversight and direction to the finances and procurement of the UTSU.
- This policy is in place to ensure controlled spending of the UTSU's funds in a responsible and fiduciary manner on behalf of its members, in alignment with the UTSU's mission and values. The procurement process shall be performed in a fair and open environment where the results of the process return the optimal benefit to the UTSU.

POLICY

- All approvals of financial purchase decisions shall be executed in accordance with the appropriate procurement process and be subject to the approval authority set out below.

Value	Procurement Method	Approval Required
Up to \$4,999	Single source (credit card may be used)	Appropriate Departmental Director
\$5,000-\$49,999	3 written quotes (credit card may be used)	General Manager (GM) /Chief Administrative Officer (CAO)
\$50,000 - \$99,999	3 written quotes	Management Committee

\$100,000 or higher (budgeted and non-capital in nature)	Request for Proposal	Management Committee
\$100,000 or higher (unbudgeted or capital in nature)	Request for Proposal	Board of Directors

PROCEDURE

5. Procurement Method

- a. Single source procurement is used for smaller value purchases and is when a single vendor is contacted for a good or service. At the Departmental Director's discretion, goods or services meeting the single source threshold may necessitate multiple quotes be received in order to obtain the best value for the UTSU. Single source procurement should primarily be used for regular purchase of goods used in the normal course of operations or where preferred rates may be obtained due to vendor relationships with the University of Toronto.
- b. Where the procurement method requires three (3) quotes, these quotes must be received in written form from the service provider or vendor and filed with the purchase documentation.
- c. Request for proposal (RFP) can be done in an invitational or open competitive form. The determination of whether an invitational or open RFP will be used, is at the Board of Directors' discretion, depending on the required good or services. Considerations can include price, availability of suppliers, current relationships with the University of Toronto, etc.
- d. In certain circumstances, the requirement for an RFP may be waived. Any situation where an exception applies must be reported to the Board of Directors. Primary reasons for exceptions are as follows:
 - i. Emergency situations where an unforeseen event threatens the safety, or property of the public or maintenance of essential services
 - ii. There is only one capable supplier to provide the good or service and no reasonable alternative exists.
 - iii. Previous issuance of the RFP received limited/inappropriate/insufficient bids
 - iv. Contract extensions where the vendor was previously chosen via RFP or an existing relationship results in favourable terms
 - v. Use of a University of Toronto referred vendor that results in favourable terms.
- e. For any services required through the University of Toronto, this policy does not apply.

6. Method of Approval

- a. For all spending approved by a Departmental Director or GM/CAO, a signed purchase order or email approval must accompany the purchase documentation.
- b. All spending approved by the Management Committee or Board of Directors must be documented in the minutes of the meeting as support for these purchases.

7. Conflict of Interest

- a. UTSU Board Members and Staff who are in the position of approving purchases, shall not approve purchases from a business owned by any employee or Board Member or anyone who has a close personal relationship with these identified individuals.
- b. It is each Board Member and Staff Member's responsibility to declare direct conflicts of interest due to business ownership, as well as perceived conflicts of interest due to relationships with business owners or senior personnel.
- c. No UTSU Board member or Staff Member shall attempt to influence a decision maker if a conflict of interest or perceived conflict of interest exists.

Terms of Reference (TOR)

The policies which govern committees and subsidiaries.

Not personnel policies. For the building policies and guidelines for the Student Commons building at 230 College St. please refer to the Student Commons Rules & Regulations.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference	
	POLICY	001	Policy on Establishing Terms of Reference	
	OWNERS	Governance Committee, Board of Directors		
	AFFECTS	Committees of the Board of Directors		
INTRODUCED		30-04-2023	REVIEWED	N/A
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

TOR-001 | Establishing Terms of Reference

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the necessary components for the terms of reference that are established and maintained by the committees of the board.
2. This policy affects the committees and their respective relationships with the Board and the organization at-large.
3. This policy describes how roles, responsibilities, and powers of committees and their members should be described and enumerated in terms of reference.
4. Article 8 of the Bylaws governs the committees and their terms of reference.

MEMBERSHIP

5. Article 8 of the Bylaws prescribes the minimum and maximum directors permitted to sit on a committee. Terms of reference may set additional membership requirements.

GENERAL DUTIES

6. Unless already specified, committees shall elect a Committee Chair who calls, conducts, and minutes committee meetings until the conclusion of a committee's term of office. In specific circumstances, the chair can delegate administrative tasks.
7. The Committee Chair, in consultation with the committee itself, shall be responsible for ensuring a committee meets all of its responsibilities according to the bylaws, policies, and terms of reference of the UTSU.

TERMS OF REFERENCE

8. Committees shall adopt and maintain a terms of reference which provides the duties and responsibilities of the committee and its members, including any financial, legal, or operational obligations not already defined in the organization's bylaws or policies.
9. Specifically, and in addition to the above, terms of reference shall include:
 - a. the individual expectations of the Committee Chair and Committee Secretary;

- b. how a committee plans to give notice for and conduct meetings, as well as how agendas, recordings, and minutes are to be created, sent, and stored;
 - c. under what authority the committee holds its powers, how the committee is affected by other relationships, and how the committee reports to the Board;
 - d. the method for how the committee will track its progress towards its objectives, and how it will improve both collective and individual performance over time;
 - e. the method and schedule which the committee will use to report said progress and performance to the Board of Directors at monthly meetings;
 - f. a schedule and process for amendment and review of the terms of reference.
- 10. A Terms of Reference (TOR) policy shall be maintained by the same committee it is set to govern, but amendments shall go through the following procedure to be adopted:
 - a. The committee which seeks to amend its terms of reference shall submit its proposed amendments to the Governance Committee for review.
 - b. The Governance Committee shall call a duly noticed meeting to consider the proposed amendments no later than twenty-eight (28) days after it is received, resolving by majority vote to either:
 - i. Refer the amendments back to the committee which submitted them, requiring the committee to review and revise its proposal accordingly;
 - ii. Adopt, or amend and then adopt, the proposed amendments; or
 - iii. Refer the proposed amendments to the next meeting of the Board.
 - c. Committees shall ensure that their terms of reference are consistent with their mandate, and that they do not conflict with the bylaws and policies of the UTSU.

AUTHORITY & REPORTING

- 11. Unless already specified in their terms of reference, committees shall be empowered to act with immediate effect, in a manner consistent with Article 8 of the UTSU Bylaws.
- 12. Following the resolved action of a committee, the Chair of a given committee shall be prepared to give a report to the Board which outlines the basis for the decision.
- 13. Should members of the Board of Directors become concerned about the resolved action of a given committee, the Board of Directors may reverse an action or amend the mandate of a given committee by a two-thirds majority vote.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference	
	POLICY	001	Executive Committee	
	OWNERS	Executive Committee, Board of Directors		
	AFFECTS	Executive Committee		
INTRODUCED		N/A	REVIEWED	N/A
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

TOR-002 | Executive Committee

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy consists of the terms of reference for the UTSU Executive Committee.
2. This policy affects the Executive Committee and its relationship with the Board of Directors, as well as its relationship with the rest of the organization. This policy outlines the roles, responsibilities, and powers of the committee and its members.
3. Article 7, Section 1.1 of the Bylaws establishes the Executive Committee.

MEMBERSHIP

4. The composition of the Executive Committee is governed by Article 7, Section 1.1. of the Bylaws. The members of the Executive Committee shall include the:
 - a. President;
 - b. Vice-President Finance & Operations;
 - c. Vice-President Public & University Affairs;
 - d. Vice-President Student Life;
 - e. Vice-President Equity;
 - f. Vice-President Professional Faculties; and
 - g. Chief Administrative Officer (CAO), serving as the Appointed Officer.
5. The broad duties and responsibilities of each member of the Executive Committee shall be set through job descriptions which reflect the expectations of each position. Each job description shall be reviewed, adopted, and maintained by the People & Culture Committee on an annual basis, with up-to-date appendices left attached to this policy.

DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

6. Except for when a matter would otherwise concern the Management Committee or another responsible party, the Executive Committee is responsible for the day-to-day operations of the UTSU and its members serve as employees.

7. The Executive Committee shall be responsible for:
 - a. calling at least one (1) formal meeting per month;
 - b. making decisions by way of a majority vote for actions that could reasonably have a significant financial or reputational impact on the organization;
 - c. preparing and releasing major public statements on behalf of the organization;
 - d. making appointments on behalf of the UTSU to external committees, boards, and other stakeholders and organizations seeking UTSU representatives;
 - e. ensuring that the individual responsibilities of executives are being performed and reported to the Board of Directors in a timely and satisfactory manner; and
 - f. ensuring that UTSU members are frequently provided with opportunities to engage with executives and other leaders in the organization.

CITATIONS & APPENDICES

Appendix 1: List of Expected Executive Committee Appointments to External Committees and Boards

- Advisory Committee on the University of Toronto Library System (UTL-AC)
- Student Advisory Committee on the University of Toronto Library System (UTL-SAC)
- Anti-Racism and Cultural Diversity Office (ARCDO) Advisory Committee
- University of Toronto Radio - CIUT.FM Board of Directors
- Committee for the Allocation of Student Activity Space (CASAS)
- Community Liaison Council (CLC)
- Council of Athletics and Recreation (CAR), + Budget & Equity Subcommittees
- Council on Student Services (COSS), Hart House Board of Stewards (HHBS)
- University of Toronto Student Initiative Fund Committee (SIF)
- Information Technology Student Advisory Committee (ITSAC)

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference
	POLICY	003	Clubs Committee
	OWNERS	Clubs and Societies Committee	
	AFFECTS	Clubs and Societies Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-003 | Clubs and Societies Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE, & MANDATE

1. The Clubs Committee is responsible for overseeing the recognition of UTSU clubs, reviewing and making allocations to clubs' funding requests and special projects requests, and assisting in promoting clubs on campus. The Committee is also responsible for revising the UTSU's Clubs Policy and recommending changes to the Governance Committee for proposal to the Board of Directors.

MEMBERSHIP

2. The Membership of the Clubs and Societies Committee is as follows:
 - a. President
 - b. Vice-President, Student Life (Chair; no voting rights)
 - c. Vice-President, Operations
 - d. Three (3) Board Directors

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

3. The Clubs and Societies Committee shall review clubs and societies' recognition and funding applications and accept or reject said proposals. The committee shall also deal with miscellaneous issues involving recognized clubs and societies during the Term.

MEETING & RECOMMENDATION MAKING PROCEDURES

4. The Clubs Committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference
	POLICY	004	Elections & Referenda Committee
	OWNERS	Elections & Referenda Committee	
	AFFECTS	Elections & Referenda Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-004 | Elections & Referenda Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE, & MANDATE

1. The Elections and Referenda Committee will oversee the UTSU's elections and referenda in accordance with its own policies and procedures.

MEMBERSHIP

2. The membership of the Elections and Referenda Committee is as follows:
 - a. President (Chair and Speaker)
 - b. Vice-President, Finance and Operations
 - c. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of seven (7) directors in accordance with article 8 section 2 of the UTSU bylaws
 - d. The Director, People and Culture, and General Manager / CAO shall serve as a non-voting members

DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

3. The Elections and Referenda Committee shall review the Elections and Referenda Code, and make recommendations to the UTSU board of directors.
4. The Chair shall be responsible for creating the agenda on the advice of Committee members, and uploading it to the shared drive after meetings. The Chair shall be responsible for ensuring minutes are uploaded to the shared drive.

MEETING & DECISION MAKING PROCEDURES

5. The Elections and Referenda Committee shall be struck by the incoming Board at their first meeting in May of each year.
6. The Elections and Referenda Committee shall meet monthly beginning no later than July and ending in April of each year.
7. The Elections and Referenda Committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.

8. Votes shall be decided by a simple majority (50% + 1) of members present and voting, unless otherwise indicated in board policies or UTSU bylaws.
9. In serious and time-sensitive situations, the Chair may call an Elections and Referenda Committee Meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.
10. Personnel and visitors may be invited to Elections and Referenda Committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
11. Members shall have three (3) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
12. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
13. Executive Assistants (EAs) may be present at Governance Committee meetings for the purpose of minute-taking.
14. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference
	POLICY	005	Finance Committee
	OWNERS	Finance Committee	
	AFFECTS	Finance Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-005 | Finance Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE & MANDATE

1. The Finance Committee shall have oversight of the financial planning and budget activities of the UTSU, including but not limited to the short-term and long-term financial planning of the UTSU. The Committee shall be empowered to review and investigate any inappropriate transactions.

MEMBERSHIP

2. The Membership of the Finance Committee is as follows:
 - a. Vice-President, Finance and Operations (Chair and Speaker)
 - b. President
 - c. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of seven (7) directors in accordance with article 8 section 2 of the UTSU bylaws
 - d. The General Manager / CAO shall serve as a non-voting member

Duties & Responsibilities

3. The Finance Committee is responsible for preparing and recommending the operating and revised budgets for approval to the Board of Directors.
4. The Finance Committee may evaluate and make recommendations on financial decisions in excess of \$100,000 not included in board-approved budgets, included but not limited to investments, real estate, renovations, and contracts.
5. The Chair shall be responsible for creating the agenda on the advice of Committee members, and uploading it to the shared drive after meetings. The Chair shall be responsible for ensuring minutes are uploaded to the shared drive.

MEETING & DECISION-MAKING PROCEDURES

6. The Finance Committee shall be struck by the incoming Board at their first meeting in May of each year.
7. The Finance Committee shall meet monthly beginning no later than July and ending in April of each year.
8. The Finance Committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.
9. Votes shall be won by a simple majority (50% + 1) of members present and voting, unless otherwise indicated in board policies or UTSU bylaws.

10. In serious and time-sensitive financial situations, the Chair may call a Special Finance Committee Meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.
11. Personnel and visitors may be invited to Finance Committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
12. Members shall have three (3) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
13. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
14. Executive Assistants (EAs) may be present at Finance Committee meetings for the purpose of minute-taking.
15. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference
	POLICY	006	Governance Committee
	OWNERS	Governance Committee	
	AFFECTS	Governance Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-006 | Governance Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE & MANDATE

1. The Governance Committee is responsible for planning and recommendations related to UTSU policies, bylaws, and other internal regulation.

MEMBERSHIP

2. The Membership of the Governance Committee is as follows:
 - a. Vice-President, Finance and Operations (Chair and Speaker)
 - b. President
 - c. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of seven (7) directors in accordance with article 8 section 2 of the UTSU bylaws
 - d. The Director, People and Culture, and General Manager / CAO shall serve as a non-voting members

DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

3. The Governance Committee shall review UTSU policies, bylaws, and other internal regulations.
4. The Finance Committee may evaluate and make recommendations on changes to said regulations.
5. The Chair shall be responsible for creating the agenda on the advice of Committee members, and uploading it to the shared drive after meetings. The Chair shall be responsible for ensuring minutes are uploaded to the shared drive.

MEETING & DECISION MAKING PROCEDURES

6. The Governance Committee shall be struck by the incoming Board at their first meeting in May of each year.
7. The Governance Committee shall meet monthly beginning no later than July and ending in April of each year.
8. The Governance Committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.
9. Votes shall be decided by a simple majority (50% + 1) of members present and voting, unless otherwise indicated in board policies or UTSU bylaws.
10. In serious and time-sensitive situations, the Chair may call a Governance Committee Meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.

11. Personnel and visitors may be invited to Governance Committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
12. Members shall have three (3) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
13. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
14. Executive Assistants (EAs) may be present at Governance Committee meetings for the purpose of minute-taking.
15. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.

	AREA	TOR	Member Services Committee
	POLICY	007	Terms of Reference
	OWNERS	Member Services Committee	
	AFFECTS	Member Services Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-007 | Member Services Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE & MANDATE

1. The Member Services Committee is responsible for the management and oversight of the services of the UTSU.

MEMBERSHIP

2. The membership of the Member Services Committee is as follows:
 - a. President (Chair and Speaker)
 - b. Vice-President, Finance and Operations
 - c. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of seven (7) directors in accordance with article 8 section 2 of the UTSU bylaws
 - d. The Director, Programs and Services, and General Manager / CAO shall serve as a non-voting members

DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

3. The Member Services Committee oversee the short and long-term planning of the Programs and Services of the UTSU, and oversee the health and/or dental insurance plans along with other similar plans.
4. The Member Services Committee shall conduct a yearly review of the UTSU's service offerings and recommend changes as seen fit given the review's findings.

MEETING & DECISION MAKING PROCEDURES

5. The Member Services Committee shall be struck by the incoming Board at their first meeting in May of each year.
6. The Member Services Committee shall meet monthly beginning no later than July and ending in April of each year.

7. The Member Services Committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.
8. Votes shall be decided by a simple majority (50% + 1) of members present and voting, unless otherwise indicated in board policies or UTSU bylaws.
9. In serious and time-sensitive situations, the Chair may call a Member Services Committee Meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.
10. Personnel and visitors may be invited to Member Services Committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
11. Members shall have three (3) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
12. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
13. Executive Assistants (EAs) may be present at Member Services Committee meetings for the purpose of minute-taking.
14. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference for Board Committees
	POLICY	008	People & Culture Committee
	OWNERS	People & Culture Committee	
	AFFECTS	Executive Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-008 | People & Culture Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE, & MANDATE

1. Per the mandate in the Bylaws and policies, the People & Culture Committee of the Board of the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) will be responsible for reviewing the performance of Executive Committee members, and evaluate the overall health and function of the working relationship between the Board of Directors and Executive Committee.
2. The Committee is positioned to broadly provide advice on Board and Executive development, and can address specific matters pertaining to organizational people matters, as requested by the Board of Directors.

MEMBERSHIP

3. The committee will be comprised of a minimum of three (3) Board Directors
4. Members of the Executive may not be members of the People & Culture Committee, though they may attend meetings.
5. The Director of People & Culture shall be an ex-officio member of the committee and shall chair committee meetings.

DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

6. Provide members of the Executive Committee with feedback on their performance and suggestions for further development, as well as highlight areas of Executive success and merit;
7. Determine the method(s) through which feedback will be gathered and provided;
8. Provide a mechanism to discuss opportunities for improving the working relationship between the Board and the Executive Committee, in order to achieve the organization's goals and objectives;

9. In the execution of its responsibilities, apply a learning, strength-based and equity mindset to support each individual's growth journey.

MEETING & DECISION MAKING PROCEDURES

10. The Committee shall be required to meet at least three times during a single Board term.
11. Meetings shall be called by the Chair in accordance with the Board agreed schedule. Additional meetings may be called by any member of the Committee if they consider it to be necessary.
12. The Committee shall meet in closed session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.

	AREA	TOR	Terms of Reference
	POLICY	009	Student Aid and Scholarship Committee
	OWNERS	Student Aid and Scholarship Committee	
	AFFECTS	Student Aid & Scholarship Committee, Board of Directors	

TOR-009 | Student Aid & Scholarship Committee

PREAMBLE, SCOPE & MANDATE

1. The Student Aid and Scholarships Committee is responsible for planning and recommendations related to direct financial support from the UTSU to UTSU members.

MEMBERSHIP

2. The Membership of the Student Aid and Scholarships Committee is as follows:
 - a. Vice-President, Finance and Operations (Chair and Speaker)
 - b. President
 - c. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of seven (7) directors in accordance with article 8 section 2 of the UTSU bylaws
 - d. The General Manager / CAO shall serve as a non-voting member

DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

3. The Student Aid and Scholarships Committee shall review UTSU policies and practices surrounding scholarships, bursaries, and other forms of financial aid rendered by the UTSU.
4. The Student Aid and Scholarships Committee may evaluate and make recommendations on financial changes to our bursary, scholarship, and related services.
5. The Chair shall be responsible for creating the agenda on the advice of Committee members, and uploading it to the shared drive after meetings. The Chair shall be responsible for ensuring minutes are uploaded to the shared drive.

MEETING & RECOMMENDATION MAKING PROCEDURES

6. The Student Aid and Scholarships Committee shall be struck by the incoming Board at their first meeting in May of each year.
7. The Student Aid and Scholarships Committee shall meet in July, August, September, December, January, and April.
8. The Student Aid and Scholarships Committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the Bylaws and Policies.

9. Votes shall be decided by a simple majority (50% + 1) of members present and voting, unless otherwise indicated in board policies or UTSU bylaws.
10. In serious and time-sensitive situations, the Chair may call a Special Student Aid and Scholarships Committee Meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.
11. Personnel and visitors may be invited to Student Aid and Scholarships Committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
12. Members shall have three (3) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
13. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
14. Executive Assistants (EAs) may be present at Student Aid and Scholarships Committee meetings for the purpose of minute-taking.
15. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.

	AREA	TOR	Policies & Procedures of the Board of Directors
	POLICY	010	First Year Council Policy
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Board of Directors, First Year Council	

TOR-010 | First Year Council

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. The First Year Council (FYC) is an advisory body of the UTSU which focuses on the wellbeing and distinctive needs of full-time undergraduate students in their first year of study at the University of Toronto's St. George Campus.
2. This policy intends to regulate the First Year Council in terms of its procedures, policies, and decision-making processes. It establishes a First Year Council Reference Manual (Appendix A), which serves a similar functional purpose as terms of reference would for a committee.

POLICY

3. The Mandate of the UTSU's First Year Council is to represent both current and future first-year University of Toronto students at the St. George Campus, and to ensure that their issues and interests are addressed by acting as a voice, and as a guiding and informative body of resources. To that end, the First Year Council shall advise the UTSU's Board of Directors and its Executive Committee.
4. During their term, members of the FYC may not hold elected office on the UTSU Board.
5. During UTSU elections, members of the FYC must take a leave of absence if they wish to run for elected office.

First Year Council Reference Manual

6. The general procedures and practices of the First Year Council shall be codified in a document which acts as an extension of this policy, titled the First Year Council Reference Manual. The First Year Council shall have the ability to maintain this document independently through the FYC Governance Committee, with the exception that all amendments must first be confirmed by the UTSU Board of Directors before they can take effect.
7. Any and all amendments to the following sections must first be submitted as amendment proposals to the UTSU Governance Committee before they can be confirmed by the UTSU Board of Directors:

- a. FYC-001 Interpretation
 - b. FYC-002 Composition and Jurisdiction
 - c. FYC-005 Budget
 - d. FYC-007 Removal From Office
 - e. FYC-008 Transition
8. Any addition of new sections must also be first submitted to the UTSU Governance Committee. The FYC Governance Committee is empowered to seek assistance from the President and Vice-President Operations of the UTSU, as well as the Board of Directors, whenever concerns or questions arise.
9. The membership of the First Year Council shall be ratified at the September Board Meeting each year.

CITATIONS & APPENDICES

[First Year Council Reference Manual](#)

FYC-001	Interpretation
FYC-002	Composition and Jurisdiction
FYC-003	Meetings
FYC-004	Commissions
FYC-005	Budget
FYC-006	First Year Projects
FYC-007	Attendance and Vacancies
FYC-008	Summer Commission

People & Culture Policies (P&C)

Outlining the UTSU's approach to people and culture.

Not personnel policies. For the building policies and guidelines for the Student Commons building at 230 College St. please refer to the Student Commons Rules & Regulations.

	AREA	P&C	People & Culture
	POLICY	001	Code of Conduct
	OWNERS	Board of Directors, People and Culture Committee	
	AFFECTS	Organization-at-large.	
INTRODUCED		30 Apr 23	REVIEWED [Date]
AMENDMENT HISTORY		[Which dept. reviewed or amended, and when]	

P&C-001 | UTSU Code of Conduct

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The University of Toronto Students' Union shall expect that as a minimum standard of behaviour, all Board members and others engaged with the UTSU shall at all times:
 - a. Conduct themselves in a reasonable and responsible manner;
 - b. Conduct themselves in a manner of mutual respect and understanding for all members of the University community;
 - c. Not engage in any activity or behaviour likely to bring the UTSU or the University of Toronto community into disrepute;
 - d. Conduct themselves in the spirit of the bylaws and policies of the UTSU;
 - e. Conduct themselves in a manner that does not discriminate, and by refraining from and actively opposing any form of discriminatory behaviour;
 - f. Treat all UTSU and University property with respect and shall not interfere with other peoples' the enjoyment of UTSU facilities or events;
 - g. Comply with the reasonable requests of UTSU and University of Toronto staff;
 - h. Adhere to the UTSU's and University's health and safety policies and to any specific requirements that may apply in the environment one works within;
 - i. Fulfill the responsibilities of their office as outlined in the bylaws and policies;
 - j. Act honestly, carefully, diligently, and in good faith with a view to the best interests of the corporation; and
 - k. Comply with relevant regulations, bylaws, policies, and agreements, including the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act*.
2. Members of the Board of Directors shall be held to the highest standards of accountability and integrity, and shall make themselves acutely aware of the *Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act* and the many responsibilities contained therein.

	AREA	P&C	People and Culture Policies
	POLICY	002	Anti-Harassment Policy
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	(ALL)	

P&C-002 | Anti-Harassment Policy

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. Further to the Occupational Health and Safety Act R.S.O. 1990 as amended (OHSA), the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) recognizes the priority of safety, and herewith enacts this Anti-Harassment Policy.
2. In accordance with the OHSA and the UTSU Mission Statement, the UTSU is committed to the protection of its employees from harassment and discrimination.

POLICY

No Discrimination

3. The University of Toronto Students' Union shall exercise no discrimination, interference, restriction, harassment, or coercion exercised or practiced with respect to any employee or applicant for employment by reason of age; race; creed; colour; place of origin; ethnic origin; citizenship; ancestry; native language; political or religious affiliations and/or membership; beliefs or activities; gender or sex; sexual preference or orientation; marital status; family status; parental status; number of dependents; place of residence; having a disability which does not prevent the performance of the duties of a position; union membership or activity; nor by reason of the exercise of any of the rights contained in the Employment Standards Act or any existing Collective Agreement or contract.

No Harassment

4. The UTSU shall not exercise or practice any form of harassment with respect to any Employee or any applicant seeking to become an Employee, by reason of any of the grounds set forth in Section 1.
 - a. **Harassment** shall be defined as any comment or conduct that is known or should reasonably be known to be unwelcome, or an offensive comment and/or action which demeans an individual or causes personal humiliation of the types listed in this policy, such as:
 - i. Unwelcome remarks, jokes, innuendos, or taunts about a person;
 - ii. Insulting gestures or practical jokes of a nature which causes awkwardness or embarrassment;
 - iii. Offensive comments and/or actions which demean, humiliate, or threaten an individual or group;

- iv. Displaying or distributing pornographic, pin-up pictures, graffiti or other offensive pictures or written material;
 - v. Leering (suggestive staring);
 - vi. Refusing to talk to, or work with, a person by reason of any of the prohibited grounds;
 - vii. Demands for sexual favours or unwanted sexual overtures;
 - viii. Unnecessary physical contact, such as touching, patting or pinching;
 - ix. Sexual assault;
 - x. Physical assault;
- b. **Sexual harassment** shall be defined as:
- i. Unwanted attention of a sexually oriented nature; or
 - ii. Implied or expressed promise of reward for complying with a sexually oriented request; or
 - iii. Implied or expressed threat of reprisal, actual reprisal or denial of opportunity for the refusal to comply with a sexually oriented request; or
 - iv. Sexually oriented remarks or behaviour which may reasonably be perceived to create a negative working environment;
 - v. Insulting gestures or practical jokes of a nature which causes awkwardness or embarrassment.
- c. **Gender Harassment** shall be defined as: offensive comments and/or actions, and/or exclusion from that to which a person(s) would otherwise have a right or privilege, which demean and belittle an individual(s) and/or cause personal humiliation, on the basis of sexual orientation or gender.
- d. **Racial/Ethnic/Religious Harassment** shall be defined as: offensive comments and/or actions, and/or exclusion from that to which a person(s) would otherwise have a right or privilege, which demean and belittle an individual(s) and/or cause personal humiliation, on the basis of race, creed, religion, colour, place of origin, ethnic origin, citizenship and/or ancestry.

Denial of Service

5. The UTSU recognizes the right of employees to refuse service to individuals who behave belligerently or abusively or who contravene the UTSU's policies related to harassment, discrimination, in accordance with the following procedures:
- a. Where the actions of any individual pose a threat to the safety and security of other individuals, employees should take reasonable steps to immediately notify the General Manager and/or their supervisor.
 - b. An employee who refuses service to an individual must provide a written record or account of the incident to the General Manager as soon as possible, and in all cases within no more than two working days following the incident.

The record or account will include the date, time and location of the incident, a full disclosure of the circumstances that lead to a denial of service and a list of witnesses to the incident where possible.

- c. A meeting with the employee will be held as soon as is reasonably possible following the incident, the purpose of such a meeting is to discuss the circumstances which lead to a denial of service, to identify any strategies which could be used in future similar situations, and to initiate any resolutions. The General Manager will inform all staff about the incident.

Harassment Complaints

6. An employee who alleges that they have been subject to discrimination or harassed may submit a complaint.
7. The employee may request that contact with the alleged harasser be discontinued during the period in which the complaint is being investigated. Upon such a request, the direct supervisor shall ensure such separation. Where separation occurs, the Employee with the complaint shall suffer no penalty or interference in her working conditions. Should separation impact the work of another employee the separation shall not be considered for disciplinary action.
8. Within ten (10) working days of receipt of the complaint, the General Manager or appropriate supervisor shall convene a meeting with the complainant. The UTSU must respond in writing to the employee within ten (10) working days of the meeting on a resolution to the grievance.

Investigation of Harassment Complaint

9. If an employee feels they have been harassed and notifies the UTSU, the General Manager or appropriate supervisor shall conduct an investigation regardless of whether a formal complaint has been filed. The investigation process shall take no longer than fourteen (14) working days unless otherwise agreed upon by the employee and the General Manager or appropriate supervisor. The General Manager, Vice-President, Operations and President shall then decide what action shall be taken. The employee shall be informed of the decision within five (5) working days following the investigation. Where possible proceedings and results shall be kept in the strictest confidence.
10. The employee shall be offered counselling or leave (with pay) during the investigation.

	AREA	P&C	People and Culture Policies
	POLICY	003	Policy on Equity, Diversity & Inclusion
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	(ALL)	

P&C-003 | Policy on Equity, Diversity & Inclusion

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. The UTSU values and promotes the diversity of identities, cultures, and experiences of its staff, volunteers, and members. Each individual acting on behalf of the UTSU has a responsibility to uphold a commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion in order to achieve the UTSU's mission of advocacy, representation, and support of the University of Toronto student community.
2. To that end, the purpose of this policy is to:
 - a. Provide clear definitions for equity, diversity, and inclusion contextualized for the UTSU environment
 - b. Articulate our actionable commitment to upholding the principles of equity, diversity and inclusion
 - c. Centre a community-based approach to equity by prioritizing and amplifying the ongoing and continuous work of equity-seeking groups on campus.
3. This policy aims to provide broad pathways for integrating equity into various areas of the UTSU's work. As part of the UTSU's community-based approach to equity, we commit to being proactive in building relationships with equity seeking groups across all dimensions of the UTSU's work.
4. The UTSU understands the principles of equity to be dynamic; in order to commit ourselves to being an equitable organization, we must be open to continuously learning and evolving with our social, political, and cultural context. With the changing nature of equity at the forefront, this policy outlines a commitment to equity that is both holistic and responsive.
 - a. **Holistic:** we understand equity to be a guiding principle integrated into all areas of our work.
 - b. **Responsive:** no policy on the subject of equity can be all-encompassing, and therefore we must be open to addressing situations relating to equity as they arise and evolve, even if not explicitly accounted for in a comprehensive policy document.

5. This policy is applicable to all individuals who act on behalf of and represent the UTSU, including board members, the executive team, staff, and volunteers. It is intended to provide a guiding framework for UTSU actors to integrate the principles of equity, diversity, and inclusion into all UTSU activities.

DEFINITIONS

6. **Equity:** The UTSU is committed to the practice of ensuring that everyone has access to the same opportunities. We recognize that not all individuals are equally able to access resources, spaces, institutions at the University of Toronto. When people experience varying levels of access at the University of Toronto, the UTSU recognizes that support and services for people may also vary in order to meet peoples' needs.
7. **Diversity:** The UTSU values and embraces differences in race, ethnicity, gender identity and expression, faith, sexuality, ability, class and other dimensions of identity.
8. **Inclusion:** Integrating equity and diversity at the UTSU will result in a more inclusive environment. Diversity without inclusion is a form of tokenism. The UTSU is committed to ensuring that differences are not merely identified and celebrated, but that resources and efforts are made to ensure all people feel included and that they belong at the UTSU.
9. **Equity seeking groups:** Historical and contemporary discrimination against certain communities have resulted in entire groups of people being pushed to the margins and prevented from participating fully in Canadian society. The UTSU aims to centre the voices of people identifying with these communities. In particular, the UTSU recognizes the disproportionate and institutionalized harms made against Black, Indigenous, racialized, 2SLGBTQ+, gender non-conforming, women, immigrant and refugee communities, as well as communities subjected to discrimination on the basis of faith, ethnicity, ability, and other dimensions of identity. The UTSU is committed to advancing the inclusion of faith-based groups while eliminating and addressing any forms of anti-Semitism, Islamophobia, etc. within the UTSU and the campus community. The UTSU recognizes that these harms are exacerbated for individuals and communities who hold intersecting identities, resulting in unique forms of discrimination. Equity-seeking groups are therefore prioritized in the UTSU's mandate and advocacy work.

POLICY

Principles

10. In order to achieve the outlined purpose of our commitment to equity, the UTSU's equity work will be guided by the following principles:
 - a. **Do no harm.** Peoples' feelings of safety, and specifically the feelings of people who identify as belonging to equity seeking groups, will not be compromised in order to achieve our goals relating to equity, diversity, and inclusion.

- b. **Commit to ongoing and continuous learning.** Building an equitable organization requires an openness to different ideas, perspectives, and worldviews. We are committed to learning from equity-seeking communities, and centering their leadership in our work.
- c. **Explore new approaches to equity informed by community expertise.** Lived experience, education, qualitative and quantitative research, and the stories of equity-seeking groups, are all forms of expertise.
- d. **Address inequity in systems and structures, not in people.** The work of equity, diversity and inclusion cannot be done with an individual focus. Our work must aim to address the conditions that marginalize people, not perceived deficits in people themselves. Inequity is addressed in collaboration and in partnership with equity seeking groups.
- e. **Practice accountability in relationship building.** Each individual acting on behalf of the UTSU is responsible for following through on our commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion, and is accountable for the impact of their actions. We will not shy away from difficult or discomfoting situations, and instead lean into those situations as an opportunity to learn and do better.

Initiatives & Campaigns

- 11. Through the UTSU's advocacy work, initiatives and campaigns of equity-seeking groups will be prioritized. This can be accomplished by:
 - a. Initiating conversations with, collaborating and consulting with equity seeking groups in campaign development
 - b. Using a lens of equity to ensure that all initiatives and campaigns are fully accessible to the campus community;
 - c. Directing our attention to the ways in which equity-seeking groups engage with our initiatives and campaigns and being responsive to their feedback.

Outreach & Engagement

- 12. In line with our commitment to supporting equity-seeking groups and embracing their expertise, the UTSU will actively seek out campus-wide consultation and collaboration for the purposes of community building and development. This can be accomplished by:
 - a. Ensuring both the purpose of our events as well as the communities in attendance to our events are reflective of the diversity of the campus community
 - b. Creating and sharing space to engage with different communities across campus.
 - c. Supporting equity-seeking groups in their own initiatives

- d. Recognizing that the diversity of experiences within communities calls on us to consult broadly within each equity-seeking group, as part of due diligence to equitable representation.

Funding & Resource Allocation

13. The UTSU is committed to prioritizing funds that advance equity and accessibility within the organization and beyond. Ensuring that these funds are accessible supports our ability to establish a barrier-free environment that embraces diversity and inclusion. With an ongoing commitment to learning about equity, we recognize the labour of community members, and must ensure equitable compensation. This can be accomplished by:
 - a. Ensuring that we are prioritizing equity-related events, initiatives, and campaigns, and establishing the necessary funds to execute that commitment
 - b. Prioritizing funding to the structures and processes that support equity at the UTSU (i.e. student aid, interpreters, outreach to equity-seeking communities, etc.)
 - c. Providing fair compensation to members of equity-seeking communities when we benefit from their labour in support of our learning and education.

Governance & Employee Infrastructure

14. Recognizing that inequities are ingrained within UTSU structures, we are committed to dismantling discriminatory practices that have been built into traditional systems of employment and governance. Our aim is to build inclusive spaces within the organization that reflect the diversity of its stakeholders. This can be accomplished by:
 - a. Relying on and actively seeking expertise to inform, assess, and establish equitable practices within the UTSU
 - b. Ensuring there are mechanisms in place to hold staff, executives, and volunteers accountable to the principles of equity.
 - c. Ensuring that the political processes of the UTSU, including board and executive elections and campaigns, are executed with the principles of equity at the forefront.
 - d. Collaborating across stakeholder groups to promote an equitable environment where staff, executives, and board members all contribute to a culture of belonging.
 - e. Recognizing that policies are an expression of the will and values of an organization, the UTSU will work to ensure that all policies are developed with an equity lens.

- f. Considering and mitigating all forms of discrimination that might occur in an employee-employer relationship, including but not limited to: recruitment, hiring, onboarding, professional development, retention, and offboarding.

Learning & Development

- 15. Guided by our principle of committing to ongoing and continuous learning, the UTSU will actively seek opportunities to further the education of our stakeholders on the subject of equity. This can be accomplished by:
 - a. Ensuring that UTSU staff, volunteers, and board members recognize their responsibility to be open to learning about issues of equity, diversity, and inclusion as a part of their work within the UTSU.
 - b. Making opportunities for further education on the subject of equity available to the broader campus community.
 - c. Recognizing that learning happens in a variety of ways - not just in a traditional education setting - and therefore embracing the different modalities through which the UTSU and its members can learn about equity, diversity, and inclusion.

	AREA	P&C	People and Culture Policies		
	POLICY	004	Accessibility Policy		
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors			
	AFFECTS	(ALL)			
INTRODUCED		Pending		REVIEWED	30 April 2021
AMENDMENT HISTORY		Pending			

P&C-004 | Accessibility Policy

PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. The University of Toronto Students' Union has a responsibility to represent all of our members and make it possible for all students on campus, especially those with disabilities, to attend events and engage with student services to the greatest extent possible.
2. The UTSU is committed to fulfilling their requirements under the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act. This accessibility policy aims to codify the UTSU's commitment to making its activities, events, and campaigns accessible.
3. This policy applies to all activities, events, campaigns, and general initiatives carried about by the University of Toronto Students' Union.
4. The UTSU is committed to ensuring equal access and participation for people with disabilities in a manner that allows them to maintain their dignity and independence.
5. The UTSU is committed to meeting the needs of people with disabilities in a timely manner and will do so by removing and preventing barriers and by meeting the requirements under Ontario's accessibility laws.

POLICY

Accessibility in Events, Activities, Initiatives, and Meetings

6. The UTSU commits its best efforts to ensure all activities, events, campaigns, and general initiatives are carried out with the following standards, where it can reasonably do so:
 - a. Public meetings of the organization shall be held in a physically accessible venue, which may include considerations such as:
 - i. A visible entrance which can accommodate vehicles;

- ii. A barrier-free path from the road and/or sidewalk to the building's entrance;
 - iii. An accessible entrance, or in absence thereof, a person designated by the UTSU to staff the doorway for those with access needs;
 - iv. Accessible washrooms;
 - v. An elevator, if a meeting is not held on the ground floor; and
 - vi. Ramps for mobility devices within the event space if there are barriers.
 - b. Materials for events, initiatives and public communications of the organization shall be provided in accessible formats of communication, which may include, but are not limited to:
 - i. Written;
 - ii. Electronic;
 - iii. Captioning or audio description;
 - iv. Brail;
 - v. Large-print;
 - vi. Reading the written information aloud;
 - vii. Translated materials for speaker of another language; and
 - viii. High-contrast version of graphics and promotions
 - c. Live public events shall be offered in accessible formats, which may include, but shall not limited to, the use of:
 - i. Microphones and speakers during meetings;
 - ii. Sign-language interpreters;
 - iii. Alternative audio recording and braille alternatives to written materials;
 - iv. Online screenings of meetings and events for remote attendance;
 - v. Live-captioning services; and
 - vi. Captioning and audio descriptions for any video screenings.
7. All events, campaigns and activities by the UTSU, which includes meetings of the Board and its committees, shall consider and implement, without request, upon it being reasonable to do so:
- a. Accessible venues;
 - b. Accessible audio and visual communications;
 - c. Dietary needs of all attendees;
 - d. Microphones and speakers have been used whenever necessary;
 - e. Visual aids (ex: slides, posters, and handouts) are printed legibly with large-print alternatives available either online or by request;
 - f. Entrances and exits both to the meeting/event and the building are clearly marked with proper event-specific signage;

- g. In the event of inclement weather, any obstructions is cleared from walkways;
- h. Breaks are provided for meetings or events lasting longer than two hours;
- i. Event staff and attendees are made aware of accessibility features on event pages and at the beginning of the event;
- j. Events should be financially accessible, with free or discounted tickets reserved for anyone with financial need;
- k. Event spaces should be in close proximity to chestfeeding spaces, reflection and prayer spaces, and all-gender washrooms.
- l. Organizers of major-marketed events run or sponsored by the UTSU will submit an accessibility plan to their primary contact within the UTSU which will outline their process to accept accommodation requests and include what considerations have been made to make their event more accessible.

Commitment to Training

- 8. All executive, directors, and all other non-unionised staff of the UTSU must complete the Ontario Human Rights Commission's AODA training within the first two weeks of their term or employment.
- 9. The Executive Committee, on an ongoing basis, will consult with Students for Barrier-free Access.

	AREA	PC	People & Culture
	POLICY	005	Policy on Conflicts of Interest
	OWNERS	Board of Directors, Governance Committee, Executive Committee	
	AFFECTS	Board, Executive Committee, Management Committee	

P&C-005 | Conflict of Interest Policy

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The purpose of this policy is to protect the UTSU by preventing the personal interest of the Board, employees, and students from interfering with their duties to the organization and avoiding any unethical financial, professional, or political gain on the part of such individuals. The intent of this policy is to supplement, not replace, any applicable provincial laws or CNCA regulation regarding conflicts of interest.
2. The UTSU is committed to ensuring that employees are able to engage with groups relating to their identification with protected grounds, as outlined in the Ontario Human Rights Code. The intention of this policy is not to prohibit or limit the participation in groups relating to human rights.
3. This policy applies to Board Members, Officers, and all Employees who can influence the governance, actions, or activities of the UTSU. This includes anyone who makes financial decisions, management personnel, or has proprietary information regarding the UTSU.

POLICY

4. A conflict of interest is a situation where a reasonable person would consider an employee to have an interest that may conflict with their ability to act in good faith and in the best interest of the UTSU and its members.
5. Conflicts of interest arise whenever the financial or personal interests of an employee or Board Member are, or appear to be, inconsistent with or at odds with the interests of the UTSU. An appearance of a conflict of interest exists when it is reasonably likely that an observer may perceive a conflict of interest.
6. A conflict of interest exists when an employee or Board member has an existing or potential interest in any entity, transaction, or arrangement in which the UTSU also has an existing or potential interest, or when an employee will derive financial benefit directly or indirectly from the UTSU.
7. The Board and Management Committee of the UTSU have the duty to manage and supervise the internal activities and affairs of the organization. The CNCA legislates that Directors and Officers are required to “act honestly and in good faith with a view to the best interests of the corporation,” and to “exercise the care, diligence, and skill that a reasonably prudent person would exercise in comparable circumstances.”

8. Directors of the UTSU shall avoid outside directorships, officerships, partnerships, trusteeships, or employment and other business involvement and investments that may adversely affect the performance of their duties with the UTSU or if their role has an impact on a financial relationship with the UTSU.
9. All employees and directors shall avoid receipt of benefits or favours, gifts or entertainment that may influence the performance of their duties with the UTSU.
10. All employees and directors shall avoid promoting their personal interests by reason of their connection to the UTSU.
11. In the course of their term, employees and directors may receive confidential information concerning the UTSU, its administration, financial transactions, funding recipients, etc. Such information shall be used only for UTSU purposes and shall not be disclosed to any third parties.
12. All employees must make a timely and full disclosure in any situation where they have a conflict of interest or appear to have a conflict of interest.

Examples of Conflicts

13. The following activities illustrate types of potential or actual conflicts of interests that should be avoided or disclosed, as applicable, in accordance with this policy. This list is not exclusive, and is intended to provide guidance.
 - a. Self-benefit: Using your position or relationship within the UTSU to promote your own interests, including using confidential or privileged information gained in the course of your involvement with the UTSU for personal benefit or gain.
 - b. Influence peddling: Soliciting benefits for yourself from outside organizations or individuals in exchange for using your influence to advance the interests of that organization or individual within the UTSU.
 - c. Other business relationships or dealings: Approving grants or contracts with organizations or individuals in which you have a significant financial or other interest or relationship, particularly if you are in a position to influence major decisions, are responsible for review, negotiation, and approval of the funding contracts, or otherwise participate in the UTSU's business dealings with that organization or individual.
 - d. Dealings with applicants: Personally accepting anything of value from organizations or individuals that have funding proposals, job applications, or scholarship applications pending before the UTSU has reviewed the applications.
 - e. Property transactions: Directly or indirectly leasing, renting, trading, or selling real or personal property to or from the UTSU.

PROCEDURE

14. The Management Committee is responsible for reviewing disclosure reports and answering questions about the application of the policy from employees and providing

guidance and instructions in those matters.

15. Employees or who have or appear to have a conflict of interest must notify their direct supervisor to work collaboratively on a Disclosure Report for their conflict.
16. Employees may be asked to disclose the conflict of interest at the start of their employment prior to their onboarding to the Management Committee and People and Culture.
17. Employees may be asked to disclose the conflict of interest if they engage with entities that have a financial relationship with the UTSU during the course of their employment to the Management Committee or People and Culture.
18. Where an employee is engaged with external entities that have a pre-existing or financial relationship with the UTSU or have the potential to become engaged with the UTSU in fiduciary matters, the employee may be asked to recuse themselves from the decision relating to the conflict of interest. If recusing from the decision is not possible due to the scope of the role, other resolutions may be explored, including:
 - a. stepping down from the external role entirely,
 - b. stepping down from the decision-making scope of the external role,
 - c. task reassignment at the UTSU,
 - d. or other appropriate measures.
19. Resolutions for conflicts of interests will be determined based on the following factors. This factors are not fully inclusive of all possible factors that will be considered:
 - a. The nature of their role at the UTSU
 - b. The nature of their role at their external affiliation
 - c. The degree to which a conflict of interest is perceived by other decision-makers
 - d. The degree to which a conflict of interest is perceived by the public
 - e. The nature of the conflict itself
 - f. The financial or legal risk presented by the conflict to the UTSU
 - g. Other factors, as deemed relevant by Management Committee

	AREA	PC	People & Culture (Board)
	POLICY	006	Social Media Approval Policy
	OWNERS	Executive Committee	
	AFFECTS	Executive Committee, Outreach & Engagement	
INTRODUCED		April 2024	REVIEWED N/A

P&C-006 | Social Media Approval Policy

INTENT

1. This policy establishes guidelines for the Executive Committee to approve and coordinate use of social media and other public relations activities (i.e. responding to media inquiries, issuing press releases, etc.), in collaboration with the Outreach & Engagement team. It outlines flows of approval from the Executive Committee to the Outreach & Engagement team, as well as processes for responding to emergent or time-sensitive issues.

SCOPE

2. This policy applies to social media content on UTSU channels and other public relation responses as directed by the Executive Committee. Its guidelines and procedures apply to the Executive Committee, and to the Outreach & Engagement team. Other policies, as set forth by the Board of Directors, may additionally be applicable when considering the use of the UTSU's social media channels by the Executive Committee.
3. Creation and approval processes for the promotions of established programs and services of the UTSU may be subject to other processes than what is outlined here. However, it is understood that the Executive Committee, as the member-facing entity of the UTSU, has particular responsibilities relating to the use of the UTSU's social media as a member-engagement channel.

GUIDELINES

4. The Executive Committee works in collaboration with the Outreach & Engagement team to plan for the strategic use of the UTSU's social media channels.
5. The Executive Committee holds sole responsibility for responding to press inquiries. The Executive Committee will determine the best person suitable to respond in any given instance.
6. The Executive Committee is responsible for providing advocacy positions and content priorities, and for providing guidance and expertise on student voice.
7. The Outreach & Engagement team provides guidance and expertise on content design, content planning, analytics, and marketing strategies.

8. The Executive Committee works in coordination with the Outreach & Engagement team to ensure the following:
 - a. All officially recognized social media channels follow brand guidelines.
 - b. Posts on official accounts are in line with our policies and procedures, are factually correct, and are up-to-date.
 - c. All postings on official UTSU accounts respect laws regarding discrimination, copyright, defamation, privacy and libel.
9. Monitoring the UTSU's social media accounts is a collective responsibility of all stakeholders within the organization, including the Executive Committee, Outreach & Engagement team, and Management Committee. Monitoring may include checking for incorrect information, emerging issues and misuse. Inaccurate data should be corrected immediately using social media and other UTSU channels, such as newsletters and website updates if warranted.
10. It is understood that the Executive Committee will work collaboratively to ensure that social media content requests to the Outreach & Engagement team are as timely as possible, and take into consideration the overall content calendar and promotional priorities of the organization.
11. For any situation which requires the UTSU to take a formal, public position, legal counsel must be consulted before any action is taken.

Account Registration, Security and Access

12. The Executive Committee must approve the creation of new UTSU social media channels. Once approved, the Outreach & Engagement team will create the account as directed, and manage it according to the directions of the Executive Committee.
13. UTSU social accounts must be registered with an official UTSU email address specifically designated for social account registration, as determined by the Outreach & Engagement team.
14. The Outreach & Engagement team will oversee the security and hold the passwords for all social media accounts, to ensure a smooth and secure yearly transition of the accounts from year to year. Two factor authentication must be used where possible for all social media accounts, and strong passwords must be used, in line with best practices for data security.
15. Executives may be assigned access based on the promotional needs. After promotional needs are met, the password will be changed to mitigate security risks relating to password sharing.

Content Approval Processes

16. The Executive Committee approves initiatives, events, and campaigns in line with the existing approval mechanisms as outlined in the Executive Committee's Terms of Reference.

17. Once an initiative, event, campaign, or program is approved, the Executive Committee will appoint a designate, or “lead” who will be responsible for approving all promotional collateral for the project. The President, as the spokesperson for the organization, is able to provide support/input should the designated Executive deem necessary.
18. In the absence of an appointed designate to approve social media content for a particular program or initiative, the Outreach & Engagement team will seek content approval from the President. The President should ensure that their role as the designate is reflected in the Executive Committee's meeting minutes prior to content being circulated.
19. The Executive designate and the Outreach & Engagement team are collectively responsible for content research and creation. Where either party identifies potential risks or other liabilities, content approval may be referred to the Management Committee.
20. A defining feature of social media is the speed at which information circulates. At times when rapid social responses are required, the President, with the approval of the Executive Committee, can post notices on official UTSU accounts directly. However the President must inform the Outreach & Engagement team when such instances occur.
21. Reposting from private individual social media accounts onto UTSU channels is strictly prohibited. This does not prohibit the sharing of posts from organizational partners onto UTSU channels.

CITATIONS & APPENDICES

The UTSU's list of active social media accounts are as follows:

- Instagram, Main - <https://www.instagram.com/uoftsu/>
- Instagram, Student Life - <https://www.instagram.com/uoftsustudentlife/>
- Instagram, FYC -
- LinkedIn - <https://www.linkedin.com/company/utsu>
- X / Twitter - <https://twitter.com/uoftsu>
- Facebook - <https://www.facebook.com/uoftsu>

Communications Policies (CP)

Outlining the UTSU's approach to internal and external communications.

Not personnel policies. For the building policies and guidelines for the Student Commons building at 230 College St. please refer to the Student Commons Rules & Regulations.

	AREA	CP	Communications Policies
	POLICY	001	Policy on Board Communications
	OWNERS	Governance Committee of the Board of Directors	
	AFFECTS	Board of Directors	

BOD-010 | Policy on Board Communications

Preamble

The UTSU is committed to maintaining a clear communications procedure that ensures it is accurately represented, while still empowering its elected representatives to conduct effective outreach that does not compromise the UTSU's mandate or the President's position as the official spokesperson of the UTSU.

General Guidelines for Communications

1. Whenever communicating about matters relating to the UTSU in a public setting, Directors must always indicate that they are acting as representatives of their constituents or in a personal capacity, and not on behalf of the UTSU as a whole.
2. All communications must be in line with the UTSU's *People and Culture Policies*.
3. If a communication is found to not be such by the Director of People and Culture, all communications must be revoked and/or deleted.

Media Relations and Requests

4. All external and media requests relating to the UTSU's stances and perspectives must be referred to the President.
 - a. No Directors may respond to an external media request without the explicit permission of the President.
5. Directors may respond to requests for comment from the Varsity or other campus media publications, provided that they indicate they are answering the requests in a personal capacity, not on behalf of the UTSU.

Social Media Usage

6. Directors may amplify UTSU content on a personal social media account, provided the post is in line with the message and goals of the UTSU.
7. All posts, whether on a personal or dedicated account, must follow the UTSU's *People & Culture Policies*.
 - a. If any post on a Director's social media account is found to not be in line with the *People & Culture Policies*, it must be deleted within twenty four hours of identification.

External Actions

8. All actions, events, protests, conferences, and other activities relating to the UTSU's external presence and/or reputation must be referred to the President.
 - a. No Directors may attempt to represent the organization without the express permission and guidance of the President.
9. Additionally, Directors may not utilize their position on the UTSU's Board to access external events or activities that they would not otherwise have access to, as such conduct could be misinterpreted as an attempt to represent the organization.

CITATIONS & APPENDICES

[Conflicting Loyalties - Law Now](#)

[Ontario Not for Profit Act](#)

[Ontario Guide to the Not for Profit Act](#)